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No Half Truths

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CJP ACTING LIKE AAP'S B-TEAM, SAYS CM REKHA P3



INDIA'S CULTURAL HERITAGE RECEIVING RECOGNITION GLOBALLY: PM P5

'A WOMAN'S NO DOESN'T MEAN TRY HARDER' P12

Strategic convergence, economic friction: The test for Rubio in India

Rubio to travel to India between Oct 17 and 22

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, October 14



The US government announced on Wednesday that Secretary of State Marco Rubio will visit Uzbekistan and India between October 17 and 22.

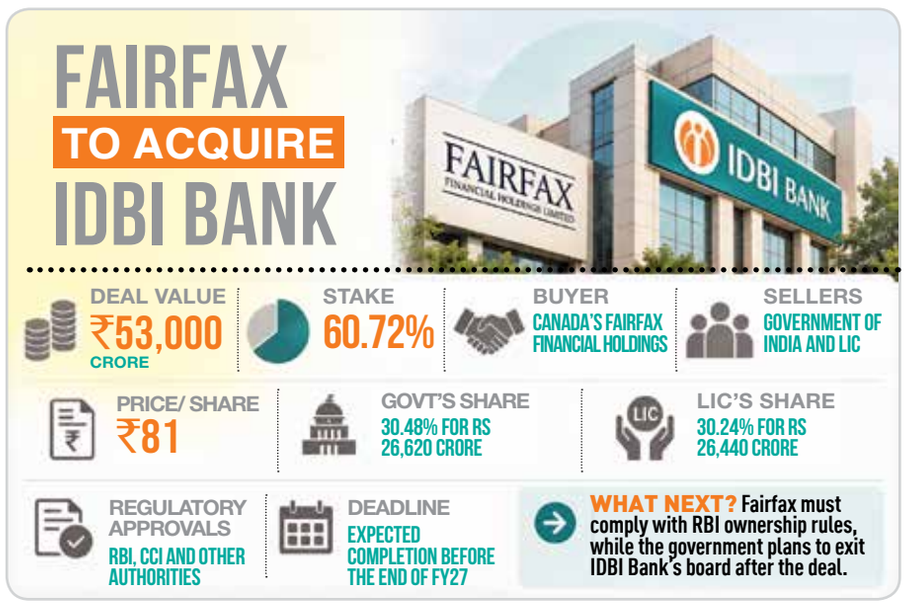
Rubio's second visit to India comes at a crucial time for US-India relations, as growing strategic engagement faces challenges arising from competing economic interests and geopolitical considerations. His meetings in Mumbai and Jamnagar, along with discussions with government and business representatives, will offer Washington an opportunity to advance its economic interests, particularly amid US pressure on India over its Russian oil imports and ongoing trade negotiations.

Meanwhile, experts believe the key question surrounding the visit is whether Washington can establish a strategic partnership with India without pressuring New Delhi to alter its independent foreign policy decisions. Both countries share interests in military cooperation and security and stability CONTINUED ON P4

LARGEST FDI IN FINANCIAL SECTOR

Fairfax to buy 60.72% of IDBI Bank in Rs 53,000-cr deal

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 14



Canada-based Fairfax Financial Holdings will acquire a 60.72 per cent stake in IDBI Bank for approximately Rs 53,000 crore, marking the largest foreign investment in an Indian bank and a significant step towards the country's banking privatisation programme.

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) has approved Fairfax subsidiary 10955230 Canada Inc as the strategic buyer for the government's 30.48 per cent stake, valued at Rs 26,620 crore, and Life Insurance Corporation of India's (LIC) 30.24 per cent holding, worth Rs 26,440 crore.

Led by Canadian billionaire Prem Watsa, Fairfax will pay Rs 81 per share, above the benchmark fair value of Rs 75.99 determined by two independent valuation agencies, according to an official statement.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman called the transaction a milestone, saying the government was preparing the bank for its next phase of growth after supporting its recovery.

"Having supported the bank's recovery, we are now enabling its next phase of growth through the infusion of Foreign Direct Investment while retaining a minority stake," she said.

The deal follows a lengthy divestment process that began in 2022 and encountered difficulties over valuation. Initial bids from Fairfax and Emirates NBD in February 2026 fell below the government's reserve price, delaying the sale before revised offers were considered. IDBI Bank shares rose 9.07 per cent to close at Rs 90.44 on the BSE on Wednesday following the announcement.

The transaction requires approval from the Reserve Bank of India CONTINUED ON P4

AHEAD OF FESTIVE SEASON

Over 11L Indian Railways staff to get 78-day bonus

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, Oct 14



The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved a Productivity Linked Bonus (PLB) equivalent to 78 days' wages for 11,40,770 railway employees, with a total payout of Rs 2,009.61 crore, recognising their contribution to railway operations during 2025-26. The annual bonus, announced ahead of the Durga Puja and Dussehra holidays, will benefit eligible non-gazetted employees across several categories.

The maximum bonus payable to an eligible employee is Rs 17,951 for the 78-day period. Beneficiaries include track maintainers, loco pilots, train managers, station masters, supervisors, technicians, technician helpers, pointsmen, ministerial staff and other Group C employees.

KEY POINTS

- Cabinet approves Rs 2,009.61 crore railway bonus
- 11.40 lakh employees to receive 78 days' wages
- Maximum bonus per eligible employee capped at Rs 17,951

The government said the payment serves as an incentive for railway personnel to improve operational performance. CONTINUED ON P4

Top Court to hear today plea filed by Rahul Gandhi, others on SIR issue

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

The Supreme Court will hear on Thursday a plea filed by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and several other opposition leaders over alleged large-scale voter deletions and irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

As per the cause list of October 15 uploaded on the apex court website, the plea would come up for hearing before a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya CONTINUED ON P4

CJP leaders sent to 5-day judicial custody; Dipke announces Tiranga march at CP

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 14

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were sent to five days of judicial custody on Wednesday after being detained over their entry into Jantar Mantar, as party founder Abhijeet Dipke announced a gathering with the national flag at Central Park in Connaught Place on Friday, October 16, at 5 pm.



CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke speaks to the media PTI

The announcement comes amid a dispute over restrictions on protests in the national capital and the detention of CJP members demonstrating against alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Dipke has called on supporters to join the proposed gathering in Delhi and urged those unable to reach the capital to organise Tiranga marches in their own cities.

A Special Executive Magistrate remanded Das and Ranka to five days of judicial custody, following which they were sent to Tihar Jail. CONTINUED ON P4

India, Canada seek stronger trade and energy cooperation



MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, Oct 14

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday met Canadian Foreign Minister Anita Anand to discuss expanding bilateral cooperation in trade, technology, energy, security and education. Modi described the discussions as productive, saying India was committed to building a forward-looking strategic partnership that benefits people in both countries.

The leaders also discussed regional and global developments and efforts to conclude negotiations on a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA). The meeting followed Modi's telephone conversation with Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney on Tuesday. SEE P4

Rahul backs injured students, warns action against responsible

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 14

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday accused Delhi Police of assaulting student activists and Youth Congress workers detained during protests against alleged electoral irregularities, claiming that a Delhi University student from Kerala had lost hearing in one ear after being struck by personnel. Meeting injured protesters and addressing a press conference, Gandhi condemned the alleged mistreatment, urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi not to obstruct peaceful demonstrations and promised accountability for those responsible, from senior political leaders to police constables.

The protests were organised by the National Students' Union of India (NSUI), the Congress's student wing, and the Indian Youth Congress against the Special CONTINUED ON P4

SC raps ECI over missing counting video

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 14

The Supreme Court on Wednesday questioned the Election Commission of India (ECI) over its failure to trace video recordings of the original vote count in Karnataka's Sringeri assembly constituency in 2023, warning that it could draw an adverse inference against the poll body if it failed to CONTINUED ON P4

Travel insurance now must for all train tickets from Oct 27

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 14

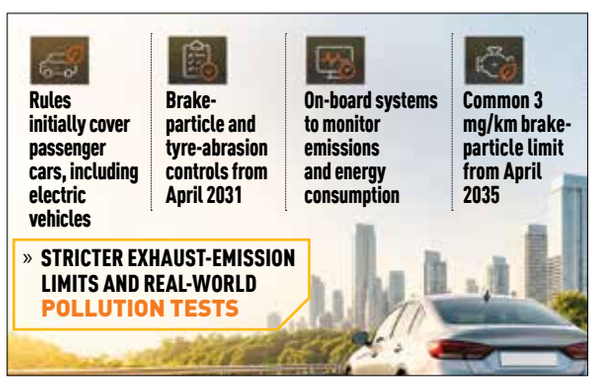
The Supreme Court has directed Indian Railways to provide mandatory travel insurance to all passengers purchasing train tickets, whether online or at railway reservation counters, from October 27, 2026.

A bench comprising Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and R Mahadevan issued the interim order, directing the Railway Board to ensure that tickets purchased over the counter receive the same insurance coverage as those booked online through the Indian Railway Catering and CONTINUED ON P4

Centre proposes stricter BS-VII emission norms from April 2029

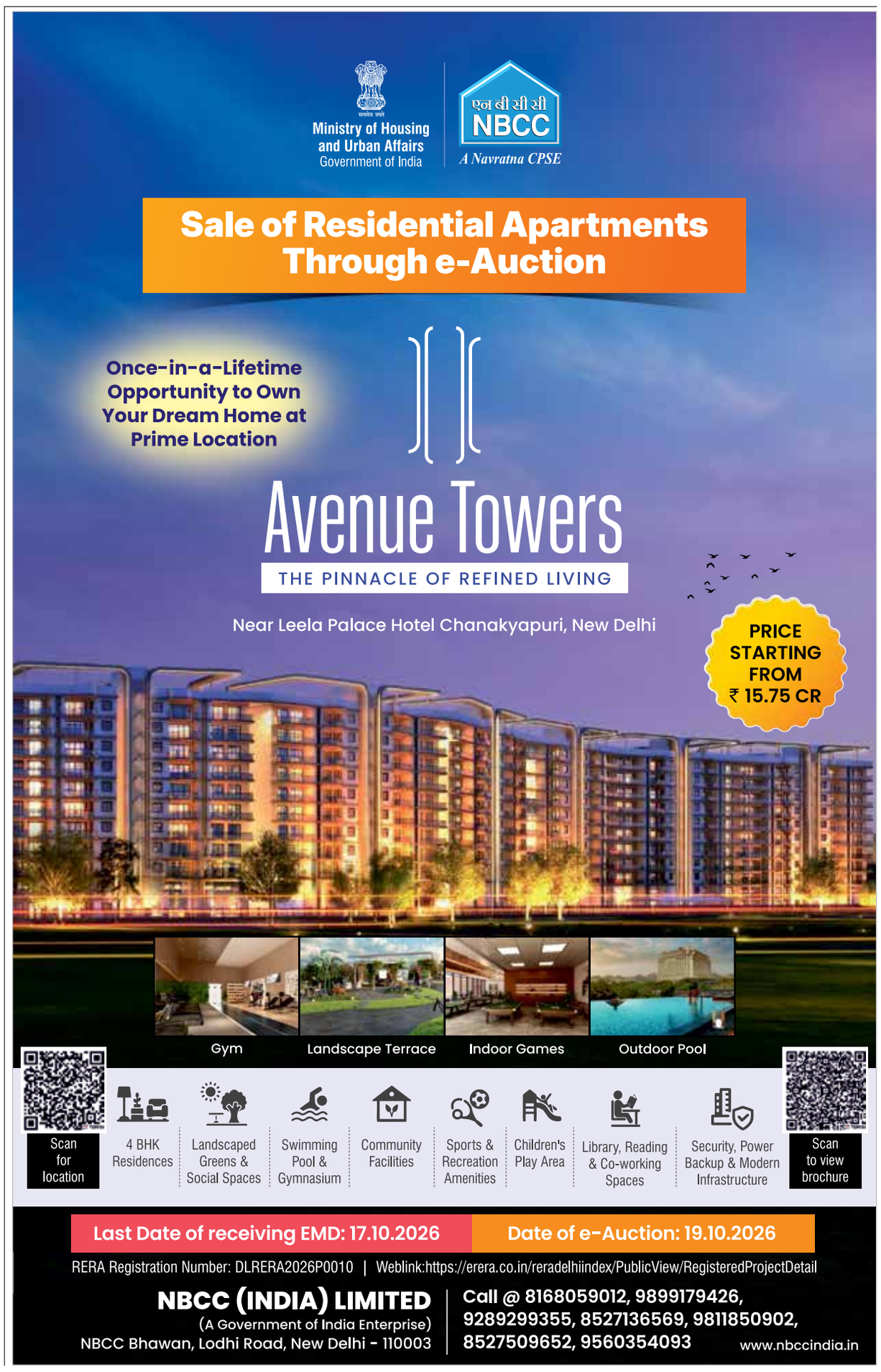
Adds brake, tyre, battery-durability rules

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, Oct 14



The government has proposed introducing Bharat Stage VII (BS-VII) emission standards for passenger cars from April 1, 2029, with stricter pollution limits, real-world emission testing and battery durability requirements forming part of a phased regulatory framework extending to 2035.

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways has issued a draft notification proposing amendments to the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989. The proposed standards would initially cover category M1 vehicles, primarily passenger cars, manufactured from April 2029. The ministry has invited public comments on the draft for 30 days before finalising the amendments. CONTINUED ON P4



AQI on Wednesday: 181

Thursday, October 15, 2026
NEW DELHI
Temp on Wednesday
MAX 33.3°C MIN 22.4°C

FORECAST

Millenniumpost

Delhi protest: 'No curtailment of metro train services,' SC told

'Protest kept commuters away, metro ridership fell by 26L'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

There was no curtailment or cancellation of metro train services in view of October 10 protests in the national capital and the entry and exit were restricted at just 45 out of the 303 stations, the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation told the Supreme Court on Wednesday.

In an affidavit filed in the apex court, the DMRC also said the number of commuters on October 10 was slightly lower than the ridership on a normal second Saturday which shows the "adverse impact" of protest on the lives of ordinary citizens.

It said over 85 per cent of metro network (258 stations) remained fully operational, accessible and functional for commuters.

The DMRC said the entry and exit were restricted at only 45 out of 303 stations, accounting for 15 per cent of the entire network, from 9 pm of October 9 till October 10.

It said the entry and exit regulations were undertaken pursuant to the assessment of law enforcement agencies and in accordance with their directions.

"The actual number of passengers who boarded the metro on October 10, 2026 was 32 lakh approx, as against approximately 58 lakh passengers on a normal second Saturday," the DMRC said.

"This reduction may be attributed to the protest, which appears to have prompted a large number of commuters to refrain from travelling and, consequently, from undertaking their usual daily activities or attending to their business or private employment," it said.



'I STATE AND SUBMIT THAT, AS POINTED OUT HEREINABOVE, THE ENTIRE METRO NETWORK, EXCEPT FOR THE 45 STATIONS SPECIFIED IN THE MODIFIED NOTIFICATION DATED OCT 9...REMAINED FULLY FUNCTIONAL THROUGHOUT THE DAY ON OCT 10...'

The corporation filed the compliance report in pursuance to the apex court's October 9 order.

While hearing a plea against the closure of various metro stations and cancellation of trains to Delhi in view of the October 10 protest in the national capital, the top court had directed the Centre to ensure that there was no "complete prohibition" of the movement of metro and trains coming to Delhi.

A bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant had also directed the DMRC and others to file a compliance affidavit.

The protest call was given by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and some student organisations against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission.

A separate affidavit was also filed in the apex court by the DMRC chairperson, who said the October 9 order was complied with in letter and spirit.

"I state and submit that, as pointed out hereinabove, the entire metro network, except for the 45 stations specified in the modified notification dated October 9, 2026... remained fully functional throughout the day on October 10," the affidavit said.

DMRC said all 4,157 scheduled trips ran on October 10, with entry-exit restricted at 45 stations instead of the 57 initially sought by police, following the Supreme Court's order.

Oct 18: Delhi Metro to start services at 3.30 am on four lines for half marathon

New Delhi, October 14

The Delhi Metro will start services at 3.30 am on Sunday on the Red, Yellow, Blue and Violet lines to facilitate participants of the Vedanta Delhi Half Marathon at Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium on October 18, the DMRC said on Wednesday.

Trains will run at 15-minute intervals until 4.15 am and every 20 minutes until 6 am, before switching to the regular Sunday timetable. Other lines will follow normal Sunday schedules.

Marathon organisers will station volunteers at JLN Stadium, Jor Bagh, Janpath and Jangpura Metro stations to guide participants. MPOST

DUJ moves SC over detention, assault of scribes covering anti-CEC protests

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

The Delhi Union of Journalists (DUJ) has moved the Supreme Court alleging that journalists were detained, manhandled and prevented from reporting during protests in the national capital on October 10 and 11. The petition, filed on behalf of its members and other affected journalists through advocate Shashank Singh, alleged that reporters were forced away from protest sites, stopped from filming and, in some cases, subjected to physical force. It also cited allegations of equipment being seized and women journalists subjected to invasive searches and misbehaviour.

The plea cited senior journalist Paranjoy Guha Thakurta's statement that he was detained on October 10 despite showing his Press Information Bureau accreditation card, without being given grounds for detention or any paperwork. It also referred to a Committee to Protect Journalists report recording at least 35 journalist detentions over the two days.

Challenging a Delhi Police advisory dated October 5, the union argued that accreditation cannot be a prerequisite for reporting in public spaces, as press freedom under Article 19(1)(a) extends to freelancers and independent journalists. The DUJ sought an independent, time-bound inquiry, preservation of evidence, return of equipment, compensation where violations are established, and safeguards for journalists covering public events.

SC advances hearing on plea concerning SIR to October 28

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14



The Supreme Court on Wednesday said it would hear on October 28 a plea seeking a direction to the Election Commission to place in public domain the list of electors issued notices during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral roll in Delhi along with specific reasons for each notice.

Advocate Prashant Bhushan, appearing for the petitioners, mentioned the matter before a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi.

Bhushan said petitioners have filed an application seeking a direction to the EC to provide an appropriate mechanism for inclusion of those voters, whose names were omitted from the electoral roll pursuant to SIR in Delhi, without requiring them to declare that they are applying for inclusion for the first time.

He said the period for filing claims and objections under the SIR in Delhi has been extended till October 30 after which the final voter list would be published.

Bhushan said the apex court had last month issued notice on the main petition and the matter is likely to come up for hearing on October 30.

He requested the bench that the plea be heard before October 30.

The bench advanced the date of hearing in the matter to October 28.

When Bhushan urged that the plea be heard before that, the bench observed, "We are thinking of passing an order that will take care of it".

On September 26, the poll panel extended the period for filing claims and objections under the ongoing SIR in Delhi by a month till October 30, with the final voter list now slated to be published on December 4.

The apex court on September 22 had agreed to hear the petition filed by Anjali Bhardwaj and Amrita Johri which also sought disclosure of criteria, definitions, algorithmic parameters and operational guidelines governing the classification of voters under the category of 'logical discrepancies'.

Recently, the petitioners have filed an application in the pending petition.

The application has sought a direction that no previously enrolled elector should be required to submit a declaration contained in Form 6 "which is factually inapplicable to such elector", and that an appropriate form/declaration be prescribed for inclusion of previously enrolled electors.

Form 6 is an application through which an eligible person seeks inclusion in the electoral roll.

"The present application raises the issue arising from the mechanism prescribed for re-inclusion of previously enrolled electors whose names have been omitted from the electoral roll pursuant to the SIR in the NCT of Delhi," the application said. It also sought a direction to the poll panel not to reject an otherwise maintainable claim for inclusion or restoration solely on the grounds that the applicant has not furnished the additional SIR declaration form.

While hearing the main petition on September 22, the apex court had told the EC that notices under the SIR exercise in Delhi were going to people "almost mechanically" and it should look for some additional safeguards.

It had told the poll panel that the basis for identifying a "logical discrepancy" required clarification.

On August 31, the poll panel published a draft electoral rolls under which 47 lakh voters were deleted from the list of 1.45 crore total voters in Delhi.

The poll panel said the SIR identified 43.32 lakh shifted or absent voters, 2.82 lakh deceased voters and 1.41 lakh multiple registrations.

AISA protests arrests of CJP's Das & Ranka

New Delhi, October 14

The All India Students' Association (AISA) on Wednesday condemned the arrest of activists Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka following protests at Jantar Mantar demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

AISA alleged that the arrests were part of a crackdown on student groups, civil society organisations and opposition parties.

It said Ajinkya Shinde, also arrested, had been released on a personal bond, while Das and Ranka remained in custody. The organisation accused Delhi Police of intimidating protesters. MPOST

After sexual-assault charge against him

ACP accuses scribe of 'casteist' slurs

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, October 14

More than a week after an independent journalist accused him of sexual assault during the detention of protesters near Jantar Mantar, Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Vivek Bhagat has filed a counter-complaint alleging casteist slurs, public humiliation and obstruction of his official duties by the journalist and others.

In his October 13 complaint to the Deputy Commissioner of Police, New Delhi district, Bhagat cited provisions of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), seeking action against the accused.

Referring to his nameplate at the Buta Singh roundabout, he alleged that the journalist, identified as Rosy, made derogatory casteist remarks about him, an exchange witnessed by his operator, constable Ravi Dahiya.

Bhagat stated that on October 3, police were called to disperse a protest organised by Neha Bora and others against the Election Commission of India.

During the operation, the journalist accused him of inappropriately touching her while he helped move a bus carrying protesters, the complaint said.

He alleged that his name was subsequently abused during a protest outside Parliament Street police station and that social media posts branded him a sexual predator.

The campaign had caused mental distress and damaged his reputation, he claimed.

The timing of the counter-complaint raises questions about the sequence of events, the evidence supporting the caste-related allegations and whether the two sets of allegations are linked.

Bhagat said the sexual-assault complaint against him was transferred to the Delhi Police Crime Branch, where it remains under inquiry.

Man throws toddler, over ten others jump from windows as blaze erupts

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

Dramatic visuals showed a man throwing a toddler out of a first-floor window while more than 10 people, including men and women, jumped from a restaurant's windows to escape a fire that broke out in the Maujpur area here on Tuesday at 10.34 pm.

The videos showed many local residents gathered outside to rescue those trapped inside. In one video, people were seen catching the toddler and taking him to safety.

A local resident said the flames engulfed the building soon after the fire broke out, triggering panic among those inside the restaurant.

"ACCORDING TO A FIRE DEPARTMENT REPORT, THE BLAZE ORIGINATED IN THE RESTAURANT'S KITCHEN ON THE GROUND FLOOR..."

No injuries were reported in the incident, police said. They said further enquiry was underway.

According to local residents, many gathered at the spot and rushed to help people in northeast Delhi. Residents said they also arranged bedsheets and mattresses to cushion falls from the first floor, helping people escape the building.

A woman was also seen jumping from the building onto the terrace of a nearby structure.

The fire erupted at Udham Fish Point near Jafrabad under the Welcome police station limits, officials said.

According to a fire department report, the blaze originated in the restaurant's kitchen on the ground floor of the four-storeyed building.

Restaurant staff doused the fire before it could spread, and a fire tender also arrived at the scene, residents said.

FIR in 24 hrs or we return, NSUI tells Delhi Police

Over 'assault' on female members

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

The National Students' Union of India (NSUI) on Wednesday said the Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP) had assured its delegation that an FIR would be registered within 24 hours over the alleged assault on its female members by Delhi Police.

NSUI national president Vinod Jakhar visited Parliament Street police station on October 14 to demand registration of the FIR. The organisation said the DCP gave a verbal assurance that the case would be registered within the stipulated period.

Jakhar warned that the organisation would return to the police station on Thursday if the FIR was not registered within 24 hours. He said the allegations required a fair investigation and accountability.

"Our members were raising their voices, and they deserve justice, not violence," Jakhar said, demanding strict action against those responsible.

The NSUI said it would pursue the matter through democratic and legal means until the FIR was registered and appropriate action taken. The development comes amid allegations of police action against its members during protests.

DDA reviews school parking, FAR norms under MPD 2047

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 14

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) on Tuesday held two stakeholder consultations under the Master Plan for Delhi (MPD) 2047, focusing on education and healthcare infrastructure.

Discussions covered clarification of Floor Area Ratio (FAR) calculations, increased ground coverage for schools, possible relaxation of Right of Way requirements for existing nursery schools and nursing homes, and a review of parking norms for private schools. Stakeholders also suggested identifying land in Narela for digital examination centres and additional medical colleges, besides reviewing disaster preparedness, basement-use provisions and planning norms in line with National Medical Commission requirements.

"THE STAKEHOLDERS ALSO SUGGESTED IDENTIFYING LAND WITHIN NARELA FOR DIGITAL EXAM CENTRES, ADD'L MEDICAL COLLEGES"

The ninth consultation focused on the Education Hub, while the tenth dealt with the Medical Hub, under the guidance of Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu.

MPD 2047 envisages a 138-hectare Education Hub in Narela, supporting universities, research institutions, vocational training and start-ups. Its healthcare framework proposes an integrated network of hospitals, medical colleges, speciality facilities and wellness centres, alongside rehabilitation and recovery facilities.

The consultations form part of DDA's three-month outreach programme, which includes around 20 sessions to gather stakeholder inputs for participatory implementation of the master plan.

New Noida gets 3 administrative circles

Noida Authority strengthens land acquisition monitoring

DIPIKA KIROLA
Noida, October 14



THE MOVE COMES AS THE AUTHORITY PREPARES TO BEGIN 1ST PHASE OF NEW NOIDA, PLANNED ACROSS 80 VILLAGES...

The Noida Authority has created three new administrative circles – 11, 12 and 14 – to strengthen monitoring of land acquisition and curb illegal construction in New Noida, also known as the Dadri-Noida-Ghaziabad Investment Region (DNGIR).

Circle 11 will be headed by General Manager SP Singh, while General Manager AK Arora will oversee circles 12 and 14. Senior managers and managers will be appointed to monitor development and prevent unauthorised construction. The move comes as the authority prepares to begin the first phase of New Noida, planned across 80 villages with a projected population of six lakh. The master plan covers 209.11 square kilometres and envisages development in four phases between 2023 and 2041.

The first phase will cover 3,165 hectares, followed by 3,798 hectares in the second phase, 5,908 hectares in the third and 8,230 hectares in the final phase.

The authority has also finalised a land compensation policy based on mutual consent with farmers. The first two phases will follow Greater Noida Authority norms, offering compensation and six per cent developed residential plots. The third and fourth phases will follow the Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority's policy, providing compensation and seven per cent residential plots.

A GIS map will guide land use, water body protection and road planning.

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STUDY SPACES, PG RENTS, SAFETY IN FOCUS

CM hears students out

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 14



DURING THE VISIT, CM SAT WITH STUDENTS AT A TEA SHOP AND HEARD THEIR GRIEVANCES

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday evening conducted a surprise inspection of Mukherjee Nagar, the Capital's prominent coaching and educational hub, and directed officials to address students' concerns over affordable study spaces, high paying guest (PG) rents, women's safety and civic amenities.

During the visit, Gupta sat with students at a tea shop and heard their grievances regarding housing, drinking water, sanitation, street lighting, CCTV cameras and safety arrangements in coaching institutes and libraries. She also directed officials to identify suitable spaces for setting up a free library in the area.

Students told the Chief Minister that high library fees and the closure of existing facilities were affecting their preparation for competitive examinations. Gupta asked officials to examine the condition, infrastructure and safety standards of operational libraries and work with the local MLA to identify vacant plots or community buildings that could be used to establish a free library.

High PG rents, security deposits and brokerage charges were among the other concerns raised during the interaction. Students also flagged inadequate hostel facilities, poor ventilation in rooms, construction-related inconvenience and concerns over food quality. Gupta said the government was working on issues related to a PG policy and additional hostels to improve accommodation facilities for students. Women students highlighted difficulties in commuting after dark, particularly in stretches with inadequate street lighting. The Chief Minister directed officials to review street lights and CCTV coverage and asked police representatives to act against vehicles using unauthorised dark-tinted films.

Gupta also took note of a public toilet that had reportedly remained closed for a long time and instructed officials to convert it into a Pink Toilet and make it operational soon. She called for regular maintenance of public toilets and identification of locations for additional facilities.

Residents and students from Mukherjee Nagar, Nehru Vihar and neighbouring colonies also complained about garbage accumulation, foul smells and irregular cleaning in narrow lanes. The Chief Minister directed officials to conduct regular inspections and ensure that sanitation measures extend beyond main roads to residential streets.

On drinking water, students expressed concern over the possibility of sewage contaminating supplies during rainfall. Gupta asked officials to investigate the complaints and take corrective measures to ensure water quality and reliable supply.

Students also raised concerns about loudspeakers disrupting studies at night and inadequate fire safety arrangements, including unsafe exits in coaching institutes and libraries. The Chief Minister called for inspections to verify compliance with fire safety norms and building safety requirements, while stressing adherence to prescribed noise regulations.

CJP acting like AAP's B-Team, says CM Rekha

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday accused the youth-led outfit Cockroach Janta Party of acting like a "B-Team" of the Aam Aadmi Party and challenged it to protest in Punjab over the killing of an anti-drug activist there.

Addressing a press conference, Gupta accused the Opposition parties and other outfits of "colluding with foreign elements" to harm India.

Alleging that the CJP never stages protests over issues in Opposition-ruled states, she challenged it to protest in Punjab where an anti-drug activist was murdered on Tuesday.

Activist Parvinder Singh alias Jhota, known for raising his voice against drug abuse and the illegal sale of addictive substances at chemist shops, was shot dead in broad daylight in a busy market in Punjab's Mansa district on October 13. "Why do they act like the B-Team of AAP and work only on agendas suited to the party?" Gupta asked.

She also slammed the CJP's insistence on protesting at Jantar Mantar, which has recently been denotified as a designated protest site, saying that they were bent on troubling Delhi people and "destroying" the city.

Despite Jantar Mantar's denotification, some leaders of the outfit breached barricades and entered the area on Tuesday, raising slogans demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Gupta criticised the Congress and AAP for their opposition to the SIR, pointing out that these parties never talk about the exercise in the states they have won elections.

She said the Congress and other organisations in collusion feel rejected by the people after electoral losses, because the public is satisfied with the Modi government's development works and the country's progress. "This is the reason why they are trying to harm the country in collusion with foreign elements who envy India," Gupta alleged. "They are hurt after losing power and are hence troubling the whole country for their political ambitions."

She said Delhi suffered losses amounting to thousands of crores of rupees, and traders and ordinary people were harassed due to their protests. "This is not the first time the SIR happened in the country: it was conducted in 2002 by the Election Commission," she pointed out.

Delhi Cabinet hails PM's 25-yr journey

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

Marking Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 25 years in public life, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday highlighted Delhi's progress in healthcare, transport and infrastructure, while raising concerns over the impact of protests against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls on residents and traders.

Addressing a press conference at the Chief Minister's Janseva Sadan, Gupta expressed gratitude to Modi on behalf of Delhi's 2.5 crore residents, saying his leadership had advanced public welfare and development. She said the Delhi government, which took office in February 2025, was working to realise the vision of a 'Viksit Delhi' in line with 'Viksit Bharat'.

Highlighting healthcare initiatives, Gupta said Delhi residents were now receiving health coverage of up to Rs.10 lakh under Ayushman Bharat, with more than nine lakh registrations and Rs.118 crore settled against around 85,000 claims. Around three lakh senior citizens had registered under the Vaya Vandana scheme, while approximately 415 Ayushman Arogya Mandirs had been established, with a target of 1,100.

On transport and infrastructure, she cited more than 5,300 electric buses operating in Delhi and road infrastructure projects worth over Rs 1.25 lakh crore that had been completed, were under way or were at various stages of planning over the past 12 years.

DELHI'S INDUSTRY PUSH: Rs 1,000 crore, 10-year plan

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

The Delhi Cabinet on Tuesday approved a 10-year Industrial Policy 2026, with the Rekha Gupta government allocating Rs 1,000 crore over five years for the Mukhyamantri Udyamshree Yojana to attract investment, modernise industries and generate employment.

Approved at a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the policy focuses on developing Delhi into a clean, technology-driven industrial hub, with incentives for 10 priority sectors, including information technology, Global Capability Centres (GCCs), data centres, healthcare, research and development, urban logistics, waste management and precision manufacturing.

The policy will offer financial assistance for capital investment, office rentals, recruitment, research, certification, technological upgrades, energy efficiency and skill development. Women-led enterprises will be eligible for higher incentive ceilings across priority sectors, while employers hiring women will receive enhanced recruitment incentives.

Under the IT and digital services category, businesses can receive incentives of up to Rs.10 crore for digital infrastructure investment, rising to Rs.12 crore for women-led enterprises. GCCs will be eligible for infrastructure incentives of up to Rs.50 crore, with the ceiling increasing to Rs.60 crore for women-led businesses. Healthcare projects will receive capital investment assistance of up to Rs.10 crore in general cases, while hospitals with at least 1,000 beds could qualify for support of up to Rs.100 crore. The policy also provides incentives for recycling units, cold-chain facilities and industry-linked skill development.

Micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) will receive support for technological modernisation, energy efficiency and rooftop solar installations to improve productivity and reduce operating costs.

To simplify clearances, Invest Delhi will serve as a single-window agency, assisting investors with site selection, approvals, incentive disbursal and grievance redressal through the Delhi Udyog Mitra Portal.

NDMC rolls out Delhi's first CNG-powered mechanical road sweeper

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 14

The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Wednesday introduced what it described as Delhi's first fully CNG-powered, truck-mounted mechanical road sweeper to strengthen mechanised sanitation and curb road dust pollution.

Virender Singh Kadian, MLA and NDMC member, flagged off the machine from Palika Kendra in the presence of NDMC Secretary Rahul Singh and other senior officials. The machine has been provided through the MLA Local Area Development Fund. The road sweeper has a dust hopper capacity of six cubic metres and is equipped with rotating side brushes, a dust and debris collection system and water sprinklers to suppress dust during cleaning. It is designed to collect road dust, sand, gravel, stones and dry vegetation, reducing the resuspension of dust and potentially improving air quality.



MCD to model 24 schools on PM Shri, CM Shri lines

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 14

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) will develop 24 primary schools as 'Nigam Shri Schools' on the lines of the PM Shri and CM Shri initiatives, Mayor Pravesh Wahi announced on Wednesday.

The announcement was made at a programme organised by the MCD Education Department at a primary school in Tagore Garden, where Chief Minister Rekha Gupta facilitated the transfer of Rs 1,370 each to the bank accounts of approximately 5.25 lakh MCD school students through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT).

The amount includes Rs 1,250 for school uniforms and Rs 120 for school bags, providing financial assistance to parents towards essential educational expenses.

During the programme, IDBI Bank provided 1,500 computer printers to MCD schools under its corporate social responsibility initiative. The Chief Minister emphasised the need for collaboration between government institutions and private organisations to improve educational infrastructure and learning opportunities.

The MCD also highlighted the 'Science on Wheels' initiative, under which a bus provided by the NGO SARD will offer students hands-on learning through practical demonstrations.

MCD surveys 30 lakh homes, flags 81 unsafe

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has identified 81 dangerous houses across the city and issued repair advisories for 553 others, according to an official report, showing that the civic body has surveyed around 30.6 lakh houses, which is 94.17 per cent of the total houses in the national capital. The report states that the MCD has surveyed 30,66,188 houses against a total of 32,55,909 till Monday, leaving 1,89,721 houses yet to be covered. The survey covers 94.17 per cent of the total houses listed in the report.

Of the 81 houses declared dangerous, 55 fall under the maintenance category and 26 under the building category, the report dated October 12 stated. The MCD, in its survey, identified 462 houses requiring repairs under the maintenance category and 91 under the building category. Of these, 63 houses are in the maintenance category and 18 in the building category.

MIN OPENS CONTROL CENTRE, FLAGS OFF RESPONSE VEHICLE

AI to spot water woes before they hit

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 14



Delhi is set to strengthen its water-supply monitoring with artificial intelligence (AI)-based systems to anticipate pipeline bursts, identify low-pressure areas and track repairs, as Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh on Wednesday inaugurated an Intelligent Command and Control Centre (IC³) and flagged off a dedicated emergency response vehicle.

The facilities were launched at JWIL Infra Limited's office on Shivaji Marg, with the aim of reducing water loss, speeding up repairs and improving responses to consumer complaints.

The IC³ platform will integrate data from Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition (SCADA) systems, Geographic Information Systems (GIS), smart meters, consumer complaints, maintenance records and GPS-enabled field vehicles. Officials will be able to monitor the water network, identify vulnerable locations, track repair teams and review complaints through a single dashboard. The system will also use AI and digital-twin technology to anticipate potential pipeline bursts, assess demand patterns and identify areas experiencing low water pressure, enabling officials to address potential disruptions before they escalate.

"For us, water management is not just about supplying water. It is equally important to prevent wastage, identify problems quickly and ensure that people do not have to suffer because of a pipeline leak or an avoidable disruption," Singh said.

The emergency response vehicle has been equipped with high-capacity submersible dewatering pumps, a 60 kVA generator and essential repair equipment. Its independent power supply will allow teams to undertake emergency operations even where electricity is unavailable.

1,802
CUSTOMERS^

6,979
SUPPLIERS#

26
OWN FACILITIES*

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^In Fiscal 2026 | # Third party suppliers, Fiscal 2026 | *As of June 30, 2026 *Map not to scale, for representation purposes only.*

ZETWERK: END-TO-END MANUFACTURING

ZETWERK MANUFACTURING BUSINESSES LIMITED (formerly known as Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses Private Limited) is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with the Registrar of Companies, Karnataka at Bengaluru, SEBI and the Stock Exchanges on October 11, 2026. The RHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, and is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of our Company at www.zetwerk.com and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited, Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited, Avendus Capital Private Limited, JM Financial Limited, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited and Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited at https://investmentbank.kotak.com, www.morganstanley.com/india, www.goldmansachs.com, www.avendus.com, www.jmfl.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in and www.pantomathcapital.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 28 of the RHP. Potential investors should rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision.

This announcement does not constitute an invitation or offer of securities for sale in any jurisdiction. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the ***"U.S. Securities Act"***) or any other applicable law of the United States and may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are only being offered and sold (a) to persons in the United States that are reasonably believed to be "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from or not subject to the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act; or (b) outside the United States in offshore transactions in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where those offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of the Equity Shares in the United States.

Adfactors 441/26

APPRECIATE PROGRESS TOWARDS EARLY CONCLUSION OF CEPA NEGOTIATIONS

India, Canada look to strengthen ties

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 14

Canadian Foreign Minister Anita Anand on Wednesday met Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who said they had a productive discussion on further strengthening India-Canada ties in trade, technology and energy.

Modi said India is committed to building a constructive and forward-looking strategic partnership with Canada that delivers tangible benefits to the people of both countries.

"Pleased to meet Canadian Foreign Minister Anita Anand. We had a productive discussion on further strengthening India-Canada ties in trade, technology, security, energy, education and people-to-people exchanges," he said in a post on X.

In a statement, the prime minister's office said during the meeting, Modi and Anand discussed ongoing efforts to strengthen bilateral ties and expand cooperation in areas of mutual interest, including trade, science and technology, defence, security, energy, education, people-to-people ties and multilateral cooperation.

Modi emphasised the importance of sustaining the momentum in bilateral engagement and translating it into tangible outcomes, including through early conclusion of negotiations on a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA).

They also exchanged views on regional and global developments of mutual interest, the statement said.

Modi conveyed his warm greetings to his Canadian counterpart Mark Carney and said he looked forward to continuing their engagements.

The meeting came a day after Modi had a telephonic talk with Carney.



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar during a meeting with his Canadian counterpart Anita Anand

After Tuesday's telephonic talk with Carney, Modi said together, India and Canada are contributing towards a "more stable and prosperous world".

He said both the leaders agreed to build on the positive momentum in India-Canada ties and work towards concrete outcomes across key areas of Strategic Partnership, including trade, energy, technology, security and people-to-people ties.

A statement from Carney's office said that the two leaders reaffirmed their commitment to conclude negotiations on a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) at the earliest opportunity, supporting efforts to double two-way trade by 2030.

"They welcomed the historic Team Canada Trade Mission currently taking place in India, led by the Minister of International Trade, Maninder Sidhu, as well as a visit to New Delhi this week by the Minister of Foreign Affairs, Anita Anand, to advance shared priorities, including trade, energy, and people-to-people ties," the Canadian PMO said.

Meanwhile, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar met his Canadian counterpart Anita Anand here on Wednesday, with the two sides underscoring the importance of "sustaining the momentum" in high-level bilateral engagement and translating it into tangible outcomes. They also appreciated the progress towards an "early conclusion" of negotiations on a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA), the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said.

The Canadian foreign minister, who is on a working visit to India, on Wednesday also met Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who said they had a productive discussion on further strengthening India-Canada ties in trade, technology and energy.

During her meeting with Jaishankar in Delhi, the ministers underlined the importance of "sustaining the momentum in high-level engagement between the two countries and translating it into tangible outcomes".

The meeting reaffirmed the commitment of both sides to pursuing a "constructive and forward-looking partnership" that delivers tangible benefits for the people of India and Canada, the MEA said.

Rahul meets Ankita Bhandari's parents protesting at India Gate

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 14

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday met the parents of Ankita Bhandari, who were protesting at India Gate demanding justice for their daughter, and expressed solidarity with them.

Bhandari, who was an employee at a resort in Uttarakhand, was murdered in September 2022.

Bhandari's parents staged a protest near India Gate, demanding that Dushyant Kumar Gautam's appointment as the Sikkim governor be put on hold until the ongoing CBI probe into their daughter's murder case is complete.

Gandhi was accompanied by his sister, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and other Congress leaders.

Later, in a post in Hindi on X, Rahul Gandhi attacked the BJP and said that for four years, Bhandari's family has not received justice, but "a 'VIP' accused has certainly been rewarded with protection and a constitutional position".

Bhandari's parents have alleged BJP leader Gautam's involvement in the case. Gautam was appointed the governor of Sikkim on Monday.

"Where rapists and murderers are welcomed with garlands and criminals are honoured with the power of authority - no hope can be expected from such a misogynistic BJP either.

"Today, Ankita's parents, carrying the plea for justice for their daughter, are sitting at India Gate, miles away from their home. I and the Congress Party stand with them - in their grief as well as in this fight for justice," Gandhi said in his post.

From page 1

Strategic convergence

in the Indo-Pacific region. However, disagreements over tariffs, market access and energy supplies reveal the limits of their convergence.

Jamnagar, home to the massive refining complex operated by Reliance Industries, places energy security at the centre of Rubio's itinerary. The discussions could lead to increased imports of American crude oil and liquefied natural gas, alongside stronger commercial ties. While this presents an opportunity for the US to expand its economic footprint and influence international energy markets, India is likely to focus on procuring oil based on price and reliability.

India's continued reliance on Russian energy supplies remains a source of disagreement between New Delhi and Washington. Any attempt to influence India's energy procurement decisions is likely to succeed only if the US recognises that India's energy security priorities cannot be subordinated to its geopolitical preferences.

Mumbai, India's financial and commercial capital, offers a similar opportunity to strengthen trade and investment ties. Discussions with industry representatives could open avenues for cooperation in manufacturing, technology, infrastructure and energy. However, corporate diplomacy alone cannot resolve the broader challenges facing bilateral trade relations. Tangible progress in investment, market access and trade negotiations, which remain vulnerable to tariff disputes, will be essential measures of success.

The scope for strategic cooperation between the two countries extends beyond economic relations. Cooperation in the Indo-Pacific through the Quad framework and other bilateral mechanisms remains central to their broader partnership. Both countries have a shared interest in regional stability and security, even as they differ in their approaches to Russia and other regional disputes. Preventing disagreements in one area from undermining cooperation across the relationship will remain a challenge for both governments.

For New Delhi, the visit offers an opportunity to deepen economic and security cooperation with the US while preserving its strategic autonomy. For Washington, it will test whether its pursuit of commercial interests and geopolitical priorities can accommodate India's insistence on independent decision-making.

The success of the visit will depend less on diplomatic gestures than on concrete progress in trade, energy cooperation and regional security. Ultimately, the visit will test both the resilience of the India-US relationship and Washington's willingness to work with a partner that shares many of its priorities without necessarily agreeing with its preferences on every issue.

IDBI Bank

(RBI), the Competition Commission of India and other statutory authorities. Fairfax must undergo the RBI's fit-and-proper assessment and submit a roadmap for meeting regulatory requirements. It must also make an open offer to public shareholders unless the Securities and Exchange Board of India grants an exemption.

Under RBI rules, bank promoters cannot hold more than 26 per cent. Fairfax will have up to 15 years to meet this requirement, with a five-year lock-in period for the promoter. Since Fairfax already owns 40 per cent of Kerala-based CSB Bank, it must either merge the lender with IDBI Bank or exit its investment.

The new promoter must retain IDBI Bank's name, brand and customer relationships for at least three years. Department of Investment and Public Asset Management Secretary Arunish Chawla said employees need not worry, adding that the transfer of management had been discussed with stakeholders.

LIC must also reduce its holding in IDBI Bank from 19 per cent to 15 per cent within two years. The transaction is expected to conclude before the end of the 2026-27 financial year, after which the government will exit the bank's board.

The deal could provide a model for privatising other state-owned lenders while testing investor appetite for acquiring control of Indian banks under stringent regulatory requirements.

Over 11 lakh railway staff

It added that the Railways had delivered a strong performance in 2025-26, loading a record 1,670 million tonnes of cargo and carrying nearly 7.41 billion passengers.

Compared with last year, the bonus outlay has increased by Rs 143.93 crore, or around 7.7 per cent. The number of beneficiaries has also risen by approximately 49,624, an increase of about 4.5 per cent.

In September 2025, the Cabinet approved a similar 78-day bonus worth Rs 1,865.68 crore for 10,91,146 railway employees. The maximum payment per eligible employee remains unchanged at Rs 17,951.

Top Court

Bagchi. Gandhi and several other opposition leaders marched to the apex court to file the petition on Monday.

The plea has sought the constitution of an independent committee headed by a retired apex court judge and assisted by technical experts and other citizens of eminence, to conduct an independent audit of deletions and modifications made during SIR within a deadline.

Besides this plea, the bench would also hear separate petitions related to protests, closure of metro stations and disruptions in train services ahead of the October 10 agitation in Delhi against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The city has witnessed several protests lately demanding the resignation of the CEC over alleged irregularities in the SIR of the electoral rolls.

CJP leaders

Ajinkya Shinde, the party's national organisation in-charge, who was detained alongside them, was released on a personal bond of Rs 5,000. He was directed to maintain peace and good behaviour for six months, according to Ratna Singh, the party's head of legal affairs.

The three were detained after a group of CJP members allegedly crossed security barricades and entered Jantar Mantar on Tuesday, October 13. The location had been denotified as an authorised protest site a day earlier.

During the demonstration, participants raised slogans against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and demanded his resignation over alleged irregularities in the SIR exercise.

Announcing the plan on X, Dipke said the gathering would underline the party's position that displaying the national flag should not be treated as a crime. He also expressed apprehension that he could face arrest following the announcement.

"We will show that waving a tiranga is not a crime," Dipke said, calling on supporters to participate in the proposed programme.

The party has maintained that its members were attempting to exercise their right to peaceful protest and raise concerns over the electoral revision process. However, permission for the proposed gathering at Central Park had not been confirmed as of Wednesday evening.

Police told the magistrate that Das and Ranka had called on people to assemble at Jantar Mantar, which they described as criminal trespass. The police also alleged that the two leaders had violated earlier undertakings to maintain peace.

Their counsel, Abhisht Hela, contested the allegations, arguing that the leaders had neither issued a call for the gathering nor breached their peace bonds.

The arrests also drew criticism from Opposition leaders, including Congress MP Rahul Gandhi, who described the detention of the two CJP leaders as an "act of cowardice".

Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi said jailing young people for waving the tricolour was an act of cowardice. He said opposition parties, despite operating under different banners, were fighting for the same cause and demanded that Jantar Mantar be reclaimed as a public protest site.

Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee condemned the arrests and called for unity to protect democracy. AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal questioned whether waving the national flag could be considered a crime, while Shiv Sena (UBT) MLA Aaditya Thackeray said the fight to reclaim democracy would continue.

CPI(M), CPI, CPI(ML) Liberation, RJD, DMK and NCP (SP) also criticised the arrests and demanded the restoration of protest rights. BRS leader K. T. Rama Rao described the five-day judicial custody as a new level of Emergency.

Rahul backs

Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Demonstrators have also demanded the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Athira, a Delhi University student from Kerala, alleged that police personnel repeatedly struck her face after she requested a female constable while being detained. Gandhi claimed the assault left her deaf in one ear.

Another NSUI activist accused a woman constable of grabbing her neck, slapping her and scratching her face inside a police bus. She alleged that her earring became embedded in her ear during the assault. Other protesters claimed they were beaten, kicked in their private parts and transported to distant locations without their phones or money.

Some detainees also alleged that police personnel formatted their mobile phones to erase evidence of the alleged violence. These claims could not be independently verified, and a Delhi Police response was not immediately available.

Gandhi later met injured students at Sonia Gandhi's 10, Janpath residence, assuring them of the Congress's support. He urged protesters to preserve photographs and videos documenting alleged misconduct.

"This is one voice, that of India, and you are standing before this protest and voice," Gandhi said, appealing to the prime minister not to stand against the demonstrators.

During the interaction, a student played Mahatma Gandhi's favourite hymn, Vaishnava Jana To, on the flute. He said, "nafrat ka jawab pyar se diya jaega", meaning hatred would be answered with love.

In a post on X, Gandhi said peaceful protest was a right and vowed to pursue legal accountability for alleged abuses.

SC raps ECI

produce the available records. A bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva rejected the commission's explanation that the footage could not be located and directed it to produce whatever records were available at the next hearing.

"How can the Election Commission of India (ECI) say that it has lost its record? Your whole purpose is to hold an election, and you need to have a document," the bench said, adding that it would not accept "these kinds of lame excuses".

The court was hearing a plea by Congress leader TD Rajegowda, who originally defeated BJP candidate DN Jeevaraj by 201 votes in the 2023 assembly elections. His victory was overturned following a recount of postal ballots ordered by the Karnataka High Court.

Rajegowda has sought access to the election observer's report and video recordings of the original counting and the recount conducted in May 2026.

On April 6, 2026, the high court ordered the recount, including a re-verification of 279 postal ballots rejected during the original counting. However, the Supreme Court noted in its May 11 order that the returning officer had also re-examined 1,251 ballots previously accepted as valid, potentially exceeding the high court's directions.

The recount invalidated 255 votes earlier counted in Rajegowda's favour and added two votes to Jeevaraj's tally, giving the BJP candidate a victory margin of 52 votes.

The Supreme Court subsequently allowed Rajegowda to continue as MLA while examining the recount's legality and kept consequential steps in abeyance.

The dispute has also triggered a criminal case alleging postal ballot tampering. Jeevaraj has denied wrongdoing and obtained an interim stay from the high court on further investigation.

The Supreme Court scheduled the next hearing for February 15, 2027.

Centre proposes

India currently follows Bharat Stage VI (BS-VI) standards, implemented nationwide in April 2020. The proposed BS-VII framework would introduce tighter controls on exhaust pollution while expanding regulation to non-exhaust emissions, including particles released by braking and tyre wear.

The first phase, scheduled for April 1, 2029, would introduce new exhaust-emission limits alongside requirements for evaporative emissions, fuel consumption, electric energy consumption and battery durability. The standards would cover petrol, diesel, compressed natural gas, ethanol-blended fuels, hydrogen, methanol and hybrid technologies, with applicable provisions for electric vehicles.

For passenger vehicles, the draft proposes a carbon monoxide limit of 1,000 milligrams per kilometre for petrol-type engines and 500 mg per km for diesel engines. Nitrogen oxide limits would be 60 mg per km for petrol-type engines and 80 mg per km for diesel engines. Particulate emissions would be capped at 4.5 mg per km for both categories.

Manufacturers would also have to demonstrate compliance under actual driving conditions, rather than relying solely on laboratory tests. From April 1, 2030, type approval would include on-road emission testing using portable measurement systems, with a conformity factor of 1.0 for nitrogen oxides and particle numbers.

Vehicles would require onboard diagnostic and monitoring systems capable of detecting emissions at least 2.5 times the prescribed limit. Systems would also monitor fuel and electric energy consumption. Fuel-consumption data would have to be accessible from April 2030, while monitoring data would become accessible from April 2032, including through over-the-air technology.

The second phase, beginning April 1, 2031, would address brake-particle emissions and tyre abrasion. The proposed brake-particle limit is 3 mg per km for pure electric vehicles and 7 mg per km for hybrids, fuel-cell vehicles and internal combustion engine vehicles. From April 2035, a common limit of 3 mg per km would apply across powertrain technologies. Tyre-abrasion limits for C1 tyres would also take effect in 2031, with specific thresholds to be notified separately.

The draft introduces battery performance requirements for electric vehicles and plug-in hybrids. Batteries must retain at least 75 per cent of their performance for five years or 100,000 km, and at least 67 per cent for eight years or 160,000 km, whichever comes first.

Emission compliance would have to be maintained for 160,000 km or eight years, with an additional lifetime period extending to 200,000 km or 10 years.

The proposed rules also envisage an Environmental Vehicle Passport providing buyers with information on pollutant emissions, fuel consumption and battery health. Petrol and diesel vehicles equipped with geofencing technology could qualify for approval as BS-VII-G vehicles. Manufacturers would also have to declare and label compatibility with ethanol blends exceeding E20.

Travel insurance

Tourism Corporation (IRCTC).

The court said railway authorities had been given sufficient time to develop a mechanism to extend insurance benefits to passengers buying tickets at reservation counters, but the necessary arrangements had not been implemented.

"We direct that within two weeks, i.e., with effect from October 27, 2026, all tickets sold over the counter at all railway stations shall also be covered by insurance in the same manner as tickets purchased online," the court said.

It added that the Railway Board would be directly responsible for any failure to implement the direction.

Currently, travel insurance is available as an optional facility for passengers booking tickets online through IRCTC. The premium has been fixed at 45 paise per passenger, inclusive of taxes, since February 17, 2024. Under the new directive, insurance coverage will also extend to passengers purchasing tickets offline.

The implementation of the order will require the Railway Board to establish arrangements for extending the existing insurance facility to counter bookings.

According to the existing scheme, only Indian citizens booking e-tickets through IRCTC are eligible for coverage. Foreign nationals are not eligible under the scheme.

After booking, passengers receive policy information directly from insurance companies through SMS and their registered email addresses. These communications also contain a link through which passengers can submit nomination details. The policy number can be accessed through the booked ticket history section on the IRCTC website.

Passengers are advised to complete the nomination process on the respective insurance company's website after booking their tickets. If nomination details are not submitted, any eligible claim will be settled with the passenger's legal heirs, according to the existing procedure.

The order makes timely implementation the Railway Board's direct responsibility.

PM'S MESSAGE TO PARTICIPANTS AT 'BRIHATTAR BHARAT'

India's cultural heritage receiving growing recognition globally: PM Modi

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has said that India's music, dance, cinema and cuisine continue to connect the country with societies across the world, asserting that its cultural heritage is receiving growing recognition internationally.

In a written message to the participants at the 'Brihattar Bharat: International Conference on Bharat's Cultural Connections Across the Globe' being held at the Vigyan Bhawan from October 14-16, Modi also said that besides preserving monuments, the government is also preserving India's manuscript heritage through the Gyan Bharatam initiative.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi PTI

Union Culture Secretary Vivek Aggarwal read out the Prime Minister's message at the inaugural session of the conference. Efforts to bring back antiquities from foreign countries have gained a "renewed momentum", while India's cultural heritage is receiving growing recognition at the international level, Modi said.

The Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA), under the Ministry of Culture, is hosting the conference themed on India's cultural legacy and its wider civilisational heritage beyond borders.

PM to inaugurate projects worth Rs 3,350 cr in Ladakh

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate five major development projects worth around Rs 3,350 crore in Ladakh on Thursday, covering airport infrastructure, strategic road connectivity, renewable energy, heritage conservation and water security.

Modi will virtually inaugurate and dedicate the projects to the nation, according to a statement issued by the prime minister's office.

The projects include a new passenger terminal building at Kushok Bakula Rimpochee Airport in Leh, built for Rs 640 crore.

Jantar Mantar belongs to people of India, we will reclaim it: Rahul

Leader of Opposition says waving the tricolour at Jantar Mantar in a peaceful protest is not a crime

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday lashed out at the Modi government after Cockroach Janta Party leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were sent to judicial custody, saying waving the tricolour at Jantar Mantar in a peaceful protest is not a crime and jailing youth for it is an act of cowardice.

Gandhi also said Jantar Mantar belongs to the people of India and asserted that "we will reclaim it".

"Waving the Tricolour at Jantar Mantar in a peaceful protest is not a crime. Jailing youth for it is an act of cowardice. Students. Youth. Journalists. The INDIA Bloc. Different banners, one cause. All protests are one: citizens demanding their constitutional rights," the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha said.



Congress MP Rahul Gandhi during a press conference, in New Delhi PTI

"Jantar Mantar belongs to the people of India. We will reclaim it," Gandhi added.

His remarks came after Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Das and Ranka were sent to five-day judicial custody and lodged in Tihar Jail for allegedly violating their peace bonds and trespassing into Jantar Mantar, which has been denotified as a protest area, police said.

Their associate Ajinkya Shinde was bound down to maintain peace and good behaviour for six months and released on a personal bond and a surety of Rs 5,000, police said.

UP Assembly polls: 3 SP MLAs join BJP

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, October 14

Three Samajwadi Party MLAs, including Rakesh Pratap Singh, who has won the Gauriganj Assembly seat three consecutive times, joined the Bharatiya Janata Party on Wednesday, in a political development ahead of the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections.

The other two legislators who joined the BJP are Abhay Singh, MLA from Gosainganj in Ayodhya district, and Vinod Chaturvedi, who represents Kalpi in Jalaun district.

Singh represents Gauriganj in Amethi district, Abhay Singh is the MLA from Gosainganj in Ayodhya district, while Vinod Chaturvedi represents Kalpi in Jalaun district.

BJP state president Pankaj Chaudhary and party national general secretary Smriti Irani inducted the three legislators at a programme held at Singh's residence, Mangalam, on Jamo Road in Gauriganj.

Chaudhary welcomed them by presenting saffron scarves. Several state ministers, MLAs and party office-bearers attended the event, which drew a large gathering of supporters and party workers.

The three legislators also completed the formal membership process by calling the BJP's toll-free number.

Singh's entry into the BJP comes after a prolonged estrangement from the Samajwadi Party. He was first elected MLA from Gauriganj on an SP ticket in 2012 and retained the seat in the 2017 and 2022 Assembly elections.

Fresh FIR against Azam Khan, others

NARESH BISWANI
Lucknow, October 14

A fresh First Information Report (FIR) has been registered against Samajwadi Party leader Azam Khan and others in connection with the Mohammad Ali Jauhar University case in Uttar Pradesh's Rampur district, after the Enforcement Directorate (ED) provided information to the state police under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act's (PMLA) Section 66(2).

The FIR was registered at Azeem Nagar police station on October 13, with the difference between the estimated expenditure on the construction of the university and the capital expenditure declared by the trust that runs the institution being the focal point. This amount to Rs 416.14 crore.

JJM 2.0, VB-G RAM G convergence: Five priority areas identified

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

The Ministry of Jal Shakti on Wednesday called for enhanced convergence between the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0 and VB-G RAM G programmes and identified five priority areas, including scientific identification of vulnerable drinking water sources, for states and Union territories to achieve it.

The other priority areas are: aligning JJM plans with gram panchayat plans, establishing technical scrutiny and approval mechanisms, ensuring seamless inter-departmental data sharing, and creating joint monitoring systems to track physical progress and water security outcomes.

The priorities were identified during the third virtual conference with states and Union territories organised by the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS) as part of follow-up consultations to the Departmental Summit on Water 2026 held on September 1-2, the Ministry of Jal Shakti said.

Addressing the conference, DDWS Secretary Ashok K K Meena called for scientific planning using the Decision Support System (DSS) developed under JJM 2.0 and Yuktdhara standard operating procedures to identify vulnerable drinking water sources and prioritise interventions based on local requirements.



JAISHANKAR AT BLOOMBERG NEW ECONOMY FORUM

EAM: LAC must be stable for normalisation of ties with China

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

The Line of Actual Control (LAC) has to be stable for normalising relations between India and China, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has said, asserting that any disturbance along the border will have consequences.

Jaishankar also linked expansion of trade and investment ties between the two countries to peace and tranquillity along the border.

"The point we make to the Chinese is: 'If you want a normal relationship, if the rest of the relationship is to move, it's common sense -- It is a no-brainer that the boundary has to be stable and that we need peace and tranquillity in the border areas'," he said.

Jaishankar, speaking at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum on Tuesday evening, noted that the situation along the LAC has "settled down" to a great extent since 2024 and that the relationship is "commensurately moving towards normalcy."

In the last few months, both sides have rolled out a series of confidence-building measures to repair ties frayed by the more than four-and-a-half-year military standoff in eastern Ladakh. The face-off ended in late 2024.

To a question on whether India would allow more Chinese investment in the country in case there was an "early harvest" agreement on the boundary question, Jaishankar broadly said that various possibilities are being looked at.

"We are now looking at those possibilities, and we have to see where we go. But we are not insisting that you have to solve the boundary issue in order to do business." "What we are saying is: the bar is lower. The bar is: maintain peace and tranquillity. I wouldn't link the early harvest to anything other than the boundary question resolution. Anything we do on any policy we have on business, market access issues will be dealt with separately."

The external affairs minister also flagged concerns over economic issues with China.

"We also have very major economic issues with China. If you look today at the trade balance, it is completely tilted (towards China)," he said.

"The tilt is extremely one-sided, and in many sectors where we have done well with the rest of the world, we have not had market access; we have not had a successful business operation for that sector in China," he said.

"We do believe today that we're not getting a level playing field in China in the manner in which we have given a level playing field to them," he noted.

Jaishankar also referred to the Galwan valley clashes of 2020 and explained how it brought the ties under severe strain.

"From 1975 till 2020, a good 45 years, no blood was shed on that border. The last time there were fatalities was in 1975. In this period, India-China relations did grow," he said.



External Affairs minister S Jaishankar PTI

KEY POINTS

- In the last few months, both sides have rolled out a series of confidence-building measures to repair ties
- The external affairs minister also flagged concerns over economic issues with China

Meerut blue drum murder case: Court awards death penalty to accused wife, her partner

According to jail officials, victim's wife Muskan Rastogi folded her hands as the verdict was pronounced and later broke down

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Meerut, October 14

A Meerut court on Wednesday sentenced Muskan Rastogi and Sahil Shukla to death for the murder of Saurabh Rajput, a case that shocked the country after his dismembered body was found concealed in a blue plastic drum filled with cement.

District Judge Arvind Kumar Mishra pronounced the sentence after hearing arguments from the prosecution and defence on the quantum of punishment. Both convicts appeared before the court through video conferencing from jail.

According to jail officials, Muskan folded her hands as the verdict was pronounced and later broke down. Sahil also became emotional. Muskan reportedly appealed for her two daughters to be looked after.

ACCORDING TO THE POLICE INVESTIGATION, SAURABH, WHO HAD RETURNED FROM LONDON AFTER LEAVING HIS JOB, WAS ALLEGEDLY DRUGGED BEFORE BEING KILLED

Before the sentencing, the court gave both convicts an opportunity to make a statement. They told the judge that they had nothing to say.

The prosecution sought the death penalty, citing the brutality of the crime and the manner in which the body was disposed of. The defence, represented by advocate Rekha Jain, sought leniency, highlighting Muskan's family circumstances and the future of her two daughters.

The case came to light in March 2025 after Saurabh's brother, Bablu, reported him missing on March 18 and expressed suspicion about Muskan and Sahil. Police subsequently searched the house and recovered Saurabh's body from the blue drum.

According to the police investigation, Saurabh, who had returned from London after leaving his job, was allegedly drugged before being killed.

Investigators alleged that Muskan and Sahil were involved in the murder and that the body was dismembered before being concealed in the drum with cement.

With no eyewitness to the murder, investigators relied on circumstantial, forensic and electronic evidence. Call detail records, mobile phone locations, hotel records and CCTV footage were among the evidence examined during the investigation. Police also questioned a cab driver in connection with the movements of the accused after the murder.

The police filed a chargesheet on May 12, 2025. On September 30, 2026, the court convicted Muskan and Sahil, paving the way for the sentencing hearing.

The prosecution argued that the nature of the crime and the efforts made to conceal the body warranted the harshest punishment. The defence urged the court to consider the impact of the sentence on Muskan's daughters.

After hearing both sides, the court awarded the death penalty to both convicts on Wednesday.

Himachal Pradesh govt sets-up commission to create new districts and sub-divisions

ASHWANI SHARMA
Shimla, October 14

Ahead of next year Assembly elections, Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu has set-up a commission headed by retired High court judge Justice Dharam Chand Chaudhry for reorganisation of administrative units including new districts, sub-divisions, blocks and tehsils.

The move to carve out new districts in the state, which will be especially prompt bifurcation of key districts like Kangra, Shimla and even Mandi could be a critical issue of administrative governance at the time when elections are just an year away. Sources said the state cabinet has already cleared the move and notification to appoint the Chairman and its members was issued on Wednesday.

The commission has not been given any timeline for submission of the report.

The issue about the creation of new districts had remained buried under the carpet during the earlier regimes of the Congress and even the BJP.

Former Chief Minister Shanta Kumar had openly opposed the demand for new districts that could eventually hit state's biggest district i.e. Kangra has 15 Assembly constituencies and holds the key to the state's power for any political party, after five years.

Himachal has a total of 12 districts. There has been frequent demand for making Nurpur and Dehra, now represented by Kamlesh Thakur, CM's wife, while residents of Palampur have also been demanding districts. All fall in Kangra.

Briefs

Manipur: 2 militants held

IMPHAL: Securityforces arrested two militants belonging to proscribed outfits for their alleged involvement in extortion activities in Manipur, police said on Wednesday.

A 39-year-old member of the banned Prepak was apprehended by a team of state police commandos, a police statement said.

Senior MIL executive held by CBI

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested Anil Kumar, Executive Director of Munitions India Limited (MIL) and two private individuals in an alleged case of bribery that took place in the defence public sector undertaking.

The agency recovered about ₹2.23 crore cash from the search of premises in Pune, Mysuru, Bengaluru and Delhi.

Keralam CM flags project delays

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: KeralamChief Minister V D Satheesan on Wednesday said delays in implementing development projects were draining the state exchequer, as costs escalated over the years.

He said the government was seriously looking into the issue and considering framing a proper protocol for project implementation.

Mann: Oppn wants to shut down Aam Aadmi Clinics

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 14

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Wednesday launched a sharp attack on traditional political parties, stating that they want to shut down Aam Aadmi Clinics (AAC), the Mukh Mantri Sehat Yojna, Rs 1,000 monthly assistance for women and free bus travel, as they cannot digest the people-centric initiatives being implemented by his government.

During a massive public gathering at village Harkhowal in Chabbewal, Hoshiarpur, after dedicating 154 new Aam Aadmi Clinics, CM Bhagwant Mann said Punjab now has 1,244 clinics, with more than 6.48 crore OPD visits recorded so far.

Highlighting that the Mukh Mantri Sehat Yojna covers 54.20 lakh families and nearly 8 lakh beneficiaries have received treatment, he reiterated that his government's priorities are people's healthcare, children's education and youth employment, not slogan-driven politics. Taking aim at traditional political parties for looting Punjab, CM Bhagwant Singh Mann asserted that no attempt to malign his government could shake his resolve as long as he had the love and trust of the people.

Sharing a few snippets from this occasion, CM Mann stated on X: "Today, we have dedicated 154 new Aam Aadmi Clinics to the people of Punjab. These clinics were inaugurated during a massive public rally at village Harkhowal in Chabbewal. With this, the total number of Aam Aadmi Clinics in Punjab has reached 1,244. So far, patients have benefited from free medicines and diagnostic tests at these clinics on more than 6.5 crore occasions. Our government's job is not to make people raise slogans of victory or defeat, but to ensure healthcare, education and employment for the people."

MP reshuffles 23 bureaucrats; Sukhveer named CM's PS, Bharat PR secretary

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
Bhopal, October 14

The Madhya Pradesh government carried out a major bureaucratic reshuffle on Tuesday night, appointing senior IAS officers Sukhveer Singh and Bharat Yadav as Principal Secretary (PS) to the Chief Minister and Secretary, Public Relations (PR) Department, respectively.

Sukhveer Singh (1997-batch) has been given additional charge of PS along with the new assignment, while Bharat Yadav has been retaining MD MPRDC with the additional charge of the PR Secretary.

Yadav, a 2008-batch IAS officer, has served in several important administrative positions, including Secretary to CM Mohan Yadav, Commissioner of the Urban Administration and Development Department (UADD), and Commissioner of the MP Housing and Infrastructure Development Board.

He has also served as collector in several districts. Yadav is known for his effectiveness, efficiency, humane approach to public service and innovative work in the bureaucracy. His experience spans urban development, infrastructure and government programme implementation.





Sukhveer Singh(L) and Bharat Yadav MPOST

BHARAT YADAV, A 2008-BATCH IAS OFFICER, BRINGS EXTENSIVE ADMINISTRATIVE EXPERIENCE ACROSS URBAN DEVELOPMENT, INFRASTRUCTURE AND DISTRICT ADMINISTRATION, HAVING SERVED AS COLLECTOR IN SEVEN DISTRICTS AND SECRETARY TO THE CHIEF MINISTER

During his tenure in district administration, Yadav served as Collector of Gwalior, Jabalpur, Morena, Chhindwara, Balaghat, Seoni and Narsinghpur.

In other key changes, Rashmi Arun Shami (1994-batch) has been posted as Additional Chief Secretary (ACS), Public Health and Medical Education Department.

Sanket S Bhondve (2007-batch) has been given additional charge of Resident Commissioner, MP Bhawan, New Delhi, while continuing as Commissioner of the UADD.

Additional charges have been assigned to several officers. KC Gupta (1992-batch) has been given additional charge of ACS, Food, Civil Supplies and Consumer Protection Department. Shobhit Jain (2000-batch) will hold additional charge of PS, Cottage and Village Industries Department.

Among other significant transfers, John Kingsley AR (2004-batch) has been posted as Secretary, MSME Department.

Several district collectors have also been transferred. These include Rajesh Kumar Ogre, who has been posted to Mauganj; Pawan Kumar Jain to Bhind; Arun Kumar Vishwakarma to Jabalpur; Ashish Vashishth to Narmadapuram from his current assignment; Ankit Asthana to Singrauli; Aditya Singh to Balaghat; Harsh Singh to Panna from Burhanpur; Rohit Sisoniya to Raisen; Vivek Kumar to Burhanpur; Parikshit Sanjayrao Zade to Shajapur; and Kumar Satyam to Harda from Balaghat. Sandeep Kerketta has been posted as CEO of IDA, Indore, from his position as Deputy Secretary to the Chief Minister.

Official portal launched to track demographic changes

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

The High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes set up by the Ministry of Home Affairs has unveiled a portal to collate data from various governmental bodies, state administrations, institutions and the general public regarding information about demographic changes, illegal immigration and abnormal settlement patterns.

Justice Prakash Prabhakar Naolekar (Retd.), the chairman of the committee, unveiled the portal in New Delhi. The link is available [here](https://demography.mha.gov.in/) and is currently accessible to all users and stakeholders.

This portal will be used by the Central govt's ministries and departments, State and Union Territory administrations, non-governmental organisations, institutions and individuals to provide information and comments on unnatural or abnormal demographic changes, causes and contributing factors, if any.

The committee will review the submitted suggestions and data to gain insight into trends in population growth, migration, fertility rates, economic opportunities, socio-environmental factors, irregular or unplanned settlement patterns, migration plans, and changes in the religious and social demographics of specific communities.

This committee was constituted by the MHA on May 26, 2026. Its mandate is to recommend a permanent institutional mechanism and framework for the identification, detention and deportation of illegal immigrants residing in the country in a legal, just and time-bound manner.

High-level Haryana delegation led by CM reaches Sweden

The key objectives of this important visit to attract foreign investment to Haryana

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 14

A high-level Haryana delegation led by Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini has arrived in Sweden.

The delegation will be in Sweden from October 14 to 17, 2026. The key objectives of this important visit are to attract foreign investment to Haryana, strengthen global industrial partnerships, and enhance cooperation in technology and sustainable development.



Upon arrival in Sweden, Indian Ambassador, Anurag Bhushan extended a traditional welcome to Chief Minister, Nayab Singh Saini and the delegation. Urban Local Bodies Minister, Vipul Goel is also accompanying the Chief Minister on this visit.

CLOSER LOOK

- Chief Minister Saini will address the India-Sweden Innovation Day on October 15
- During the delegation's visit, special emphasis will be placed on promoting sister-city partnerships and cooperation between cities

Chief Minister Saini will address the India-Sweden Innovation Day on October 15. On this occasion, he will hold high-level meetings with Swedish government representatives, global industry leaders, and potential investors. The meetings will include detailed discussions on investment opportunities in the energy, home furnishing, real estate, defence, and automobile sectors.

During the delegation's visit, special emphasis will be placed on promoting sister-city partnerships and cooperation between cities. This is expected to open up new opportunities in sustainable urban development, the exchange of technological knowledge, and modern urban management.

EDITORIAL

Immunity Without Impunity

The independence of the Election Commission is indispensable to the survival of Indian democracy. Yet independence cannot be confused with immunity from accountability. The Supreme Court's decision to seek responses to a challenge against statutory protection granted to the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners raises a constitutional question of exceptional importance: can those entrusted with safeguarding the electoral process be insulated from legal scrutiny? The answer must be guided not by political convenience or institutional prestige, but by the fundamental principle that no public authority stands above the law. An institution responsible for ensuring free and fair elections cannot demand unquestioning public trust while remaining beyond meaningful examination of its own conduct.

The need to protect Election Commissioners from frivolous litigation and politically motivated harassment is undeniable. Electoral decisions frequently disappoint powerful parties, and an independent Commission must be able to discharge its responsibilities without fearing prosecution whenever its judgments provoke controversy. Constitutional functionaries cannot operate effectively under the constant threat of retaliatory legal proceedings. However, protection against harassment is fundamentally different from immunity that could obstruct accountability for serious misconduct. Section 16 of the 2023 law governing the appointment and service conditions of Election Commissioners provides protection against civil and criminal proceedings concerning acts or statements made in the course of official duties. Its breadth demands careful judicial examination. The central issue is whether such protection merely shields legitimate decision-making or could also prevent scrutiny of actions allegedly involving deliberate abuse of authority. A democratic Constitution cannot permit the boundaries of official duty to become an impenetrable refuge from the consequences of wrongdoing.

The controversy also exposes a deeper institutional concern. Public confidence in elections depends not only on the actual impartiality of electoral authorities but also on the visibility of their accountability. When electoral rolls, polling procedures or administrative decisions become contentious, citizens must have confidence that complaints can be examined through credible, independent mechanisms. Judicial review remains an essential constitutional safeguard, but its effectiveness should not depend upon excessively narrow interpretations of available remedies. Parliament has the authority to establish reasonable protections for constitutional officeholders; it does not follow that every statutory safeguard is automatically consistent with constitutional accountability. The Supreme Court must therefore distinguish between decisions taken honestly within lawful authority and conduct that may warrant investigation or legal consequences.

Ultimately, the strength of the Election Commission lies neither in statutory privilege nor in insulation from criticism. It rests upon independence, transparency, fairness and public confidence. Any legal protection must be proportionate to the legitimate purpose it serves and must not extinguish remedies against demonstrable wrongdoing. Equally, accountability mechanisms must not become weapons for political intimidation. The constitutional balance requires both institutional freedom and enforceable responsibility. India's electoral democracy deserves Commissioners who can act fearlessly, but never with impunity. The law must protect their independence without placing their conduct beyond the reach of justice.

LETTER

letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Market Expectations

Jio Platforms' upcoming IPO marks a significant milestone for India's digital economy. Its massive valuation reflects growing investor confidence in the country's telecommunications and technology sectors. However, retail investors must exercise caution and assess long-term fundamentals rather than succumb to market excitement. Transparency and fair pricing remain essential.

AMAN SHARMA,
NAGPUR

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Making of a 'Model School'

Beyond textbooks and examinations, Sanskardeep Vidyalaya in Gujarat combines modern technology, vocational training and community participation to nurture confident, well-rounded young minds

NEXUS OF GOOD



ANIL SWARUP

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND A FORMER CIVIL SERVANT



Sanskardeep Vidyalaya offers an inspiring blueprint for transforming India's school education system

I was visiting Ankleshwar, Gujarat, after almost three decades. This industrial city had been transformed (though the streets were still strewn with waste), but the people were just the same—friendly and welcoming. What surprised me, pleasantly though, was what I witnessed at Sanskardeep Vidyalaya, run by the Sanskardeep Trust.

The school was founded in 1991 with the aim of fostering quality education in the Gujarati language, the mother tongue of the majority of people working in the industries of Ankleshwar and neighbouring villages. Right from the beginning, the focus has been on both academic and non-academic areas. Children's oratory skills and confidence-building are developed through a systematic process. Every student in each class gets an opportunity to speak for three minutes in every period, every day, in a language of their choice, on a subject of their choice, either in English, Hindi or Gujarati. Though the medium of instruction is Gujarati, special efforts are made to improve proficiency in English. All the classrooms, from pre-primary to Class 10, have been equipped with smart boards to make education more interesting and interactive. Students learn to operate the smart boards under the guidance of teachers. A new initiative has been introduced this year to encourage learning through debates and discussions rather than memorisation or rote learning.

Non-academic facilities are provided on the school campus for the overall development of students. A four-year syllabus has been designed by the school management for students from Classes 6 to 9, covering various vocational subjects. Each week, one period of 50 minutes is dedicated to vocational education, during which students are taught various basic life skills, such as plumbing, electrical work, repairing simple household appliances, gardening, cooking, basic agriculture, simple stitching and repairing clothes, among others. Both boys and girls learn all these skills.

A state-of-the-art laboratory has been developed to provide knowledge in the fields of robotics and AI, as these are essential for the future. A Science Park, equipped with various science models, has been established in an open space. Instead of merely learning from textbooks in classrooms, students understand basic concepts practically with the help of interactive models. These principles are explained by the students themselves to students visiting from other schools. They receive intensive training under the supervision of the subject teacher. This park is open to students from other schools for educational trips, along with the STEM Laboratory and the Astronomy Education Centre.

INSTEAD OF MERELY LEARNING FROM TEXTBOOKS, STUDENTS UNDERSTAND BASIC CONCEPTS PRACTICALLY WITH THE HELP OF INTERACTIVE MODELS

A well-equipped STEM Laboratory has been developed for students. One period is allocated each week to conduct science experiments and develop projects based on scientific principles. Students make many models and participate in science fairs organised by the government. The school also has a small planetarium that can seat 25 students at a time, with a dedicated teacher to explain fascinating facts about space and the universe. One period of 50 minutes is allocated every week.

A counselling centre has been established for students and parents who wish to avail themselves of its services to identify and resolve various issues. It is run by a qualified professional. The services provided include speech therapy, support for ADHD-related issues, hyperactivity and other special needs.

An open gymnasium has been constructed for the physical development of students alongside their education. Apart from this, there is a volleyball court, a basketball court and an open playground available for students to practise and improve their physical performance.

An open stage has been constructed to host cultural programmes and nurture the talents and skills of students. Every class participates in activities in the form of dances and one-act plays.

The Janani Chintan Sabha (Mothers' Reflection Forum) has been running successfully for the past 20 years. On the last working day of every month, mothers gather and listen to an eminent motivational speaker on various topics related to child development and parenting guidelines. The topics cover children's food habits, health issues, education, upbringing and moral values. Nearly 250 to 300 mothers attend every month.

The Vatsalya Garbha Sanskar and Samvardhan Kendra provides assistance and guidance during pregnancy and in nurturing infants up to the age of three years. Garbha Sanskar trains mothers-to-be in meditation, simple yoga exercises and breathing techniques. They are given guidance on good nutrition, positive thoughts and conversations with the child in their womb by professional doctors and other experts. They are encouraged to read good books and remain cheerful and happy. The child's father and grandparents are also invited to a few sessions to form a loving bond with the child. Under the Baal Samvardhan programme, mothers are guided in bringing up their children up to the age of three years. The importance of breastfeeding and techniques of breastfeeding are explained, bathing and oil massage techniques for children are taught, and information about vaccination schedules is provided. Cases of postpartum depression are also addressed with help from professionals. Diet and home remedies for simple illnesses are also discussed. The importance of supportive fathers is also emphasised.

It was heartening to find such a comprehensive school in a remote part of the country. It presents a wonderful example of the Nexus of Good that can be replicated.

Views expressed are personal

Starlink Cannot Dictate India's Rules

As Musk expands Starlink in India, security and sovereignty must remain paramount

STRATEGIC AUTONOMY



RANJAN MUKHERJEE

THE WRITER IS A SENIOR IAF OFFICER



Elon Musk must respect India's laws before pursuing his satellite internet ambitions

Commercial enterprises naturally seek to maximise profits. Elon Musk, one of the world's wealthiest entrepreneurs, has built an empire spanning electric vehicles, space technology, artificial intelligence and social media. However, his growing economic and political influence raises serious questions about the relationship between private commercial interests, public policy and national sovereignty.

Musk's financial support for Donald Trump's 2024 presidential campaign demonstrated his willingness to influence political outcomes. Against this background, India's approach to his satellite internet venture, Starlink, must prioritise transparent regulation, fair competition and national security.

Commercial Ambitions and Regulatory Challenges

Starlink promises high-speed internet connectivity through satellites, potentially benefiting remote villages, mountainous regions and border areas where conventional broadband infrastructure remains inadequate. Its technology could significantly advance India's digital inclusion.

However, commercial opportunity cannot override Indian laws. Musk has criticised obstacles to Starlink's entry into a market dominated by established operators, including Reliance Jio and Bharti Airtel. While competition concerns deserve examination, neither foreign corporate influence nor domestic business interests should determine government policy.

In 2021, India's Department of Telecommunications stated that Starlink lacked the necessary licence and directed it to stop accepting bookings. The company subsequently received a telecommunications licence in June 2025. However, licensing does not automatically authorise commercial operations. Spectrum assignment, security clearances and other regulatory requirements remain separate considerations.

The debate over spectrum allocation also demands clarity. The Supreme Court's 2012 judgment on natural resources emphasised transparency and fairness without mandating auctions in every circumstance. Satellite spectrum has distinct technical considerations. The government's administrative-allocation framework must therefore be legally sound, economically justified and uniformly applied.

National Security Cannot Be Compromised

Satellite internet can become critical communications infrastructure, affecting defence, intelligence, disaster management, border security and internal stability.

India must scrutinise Starlink's network architecture, traffic routing, data protection arrangements and compliance with lawful interception and emergency restrictions.

The Ukraine conflict has demonstrated satellite communications' strategic importance. Starlink helped maintain connectivity during wartime, illustrating both technological benefits and the considerable influence accompanying control over such networks.

Cybersecurity threats, misinformation and hostile digital activities also require attention. However, security assessments must rest on verifiable evidence rather than unsupported allegations. Foreign and domestic operators must face identical scrutiny.

NO ENTREPRENEUR, HOWEVER POWERFUL, STANDS ABOVE INDIAN LAW

Data Sovereignty and Corporate Accountability

Musk's acquisition of Twitter, subsequently renamed X, expanded his influence over global information flows. His interests in artificial intelligence and satellite communications further underline concerns about concentrated technological power.

Questions surrounding data protection and accountability deserve rigorous examination. Any allegation of unlawful data transfers or misuse must nevertheless be supported by credible evidence.

India must insist on enforceable data-protection obligations, independent security audits, transparency regarding information access and meaningful penalties for violations.

Corporate assurances alone cannot guarantee national security. The decisive considerations must be technological architecture, legal accountability, operational transparency and the government's ability to enforce compliance.

Political Influence and Public Interest

Musk's substantial political spending in the United States highlights the influence wealthy entrepreneurs can exercise over democratic processes. However, allegations of improper lobbying or manipulation of Indian policy require credible substantiation.

No corporation should use financial strength, technological superiority or public platforms to pressure sovereign governments. Equally, criticism of corporate conduct must not replace objective regulatory scrutiny.

The principle is straightforward: no entrepreneur, however powerful, stands above Indian law.

Balancing Connectivity and Sovereignty

Satellite broadband could transform rural India by improving education, telemedicine, digital banking, e-governance and economic opportunities. In geographically isolated regions, it could complement existing broadband networks.

India should therefore evaluate Starlink on its technological merits while safeguarding strategic interests.

Before commercial operations commence, authorities must conduct comprehensive security assessments covering network vulnerabilities, defence implications, lawful interception, emergency compliance, cybersecurity and data protection.

Fair competition is equally essential. Starlink, Reliance Jio, Bharti Airtel and other eligible operators must operate under transparent, uniform regulations without favouritism or discrimination.

Rural consumers must receive affordable services, transparent pricing and effective grievance-redressal mechanisms. Connectivity should serve underserved communities rather than merely create lucrative markets.

Simultaneously, India must strengthen indigenous satellite communications, space technology and secure networking capabilities. Excessive dependence on any single foreign provider could undermine long-term technological resilience.

Musk's entrepreneurial achievements deserve recognition, but commercial success cannot confer an automatic right to operate in India.

India should neither reject Starlink because it is foreign nor grant unrestricted access because its technology promises faster connectivity. Approval must depend on demonstrable public benefit, legal compliance, fair competition and comprehensive security clearance.

Operators meeting prescribed standards should compete fairly. Those failing to satisfy them must face appropriate regulatory action.

The message must be clear: India welcomes technology, investment and innovation, but not at the cost of national security, data sovereignty or the rule of law. No individual, corporation or business empire can be allowed to place its commercial interests above India's national interest.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Ex-Ukrainian officer goes on trial over Nord Stream blasts

HAMBURG: A former Ukrainian army officer went on trial in Germany on Wednesday over the undersea explosions four years ago that damaged the Nord Stream gas pipelines linking Russia and Germany in what is considered one of Europe's biggest acts of sabotage since World War II.

In a trial expected to last months, the suspect faces charges of causing an explosion, damaging property, disrupting public service and being an "accomplice to war crimes" by attacking civilian infrastructure, according to prosecutors.

Gunman kills 4 people in shooting in South Africa

JOHANNESBURG: A gunman fired on a group of mourners leaving a memorial service for a local politician in South Africa, killing at least four people and injuring three others, police said Wednesday.

At least one of those wounded in the shooting late Tuesday in Katlehong township was a child, according to police. Police initially said two men died at the scene southeast of Johannesburg, but authorities raised the death toll to four after two more people died in a hospital on Wednesday.

'Three Indians killed in Germany building fire'

LONDON: Three Indian nationals were killed in a fire at a residential building in the German city of Bochum, local media reported on Wednesday.

The victims were two women aged 25 and 27, and a 26-year-old man, all Indian nationals, German public broadcaster WDR (Westdeutscher Rundfunk) reported, citing details released by Bochum police. Their names and home states in India were not reported.

Five other people were also injured in the incident that occurred early Tuesday.



Supporters of Brazilian President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva, attend a rally ahead of the presidential runoff election in Sao Paulo on Tuesday AP/PTI

Briefs

Iran executes man accused of armed op

DUBAI: Iran on Wednesday hanged a man accused of an "armed operation" against the theocracy in support of exiled former Crown Prince Reza Pahlavi.

A report by Mizan, an outlet affiliated with the Islamic Republic's judiciary, identified the man as Ali Sina Mostafavi and said he opened fire earlier during the Iran war and injured several people including Kerman.

Indian national held in Nepal

KATHMANDU: An Indian national has been arrested and remanded in judicial custody for five days in Nepal on charges of sexually abusing a 17-year-old girl, police said on Wednesday.

The accused, identified as Jinha, 40, was arrested from his rented room in Kalimati, on the outskirts of Kathmandu, on Saturday. The girl worked at a garment factory run by him.

Kenya confirms 2nd Ebola case

NAIROBI: Kenya's Health Ministry confirmed the country's second Ebola case Wednesday, saying a relative of the man who died two days after arriving from Congo had tested positive while in quarantine.

The ministry said the 39-year-old man had been identified as a close relative of Kenya's first Ebola case and developed symptoms Tuesday.

Clashes erupt in Albania

TIRANA: Police fired water cannons at student protesters in Albania's capital Wednesday as clashes continued for a second day, with demonstrators joining a broader anti-government campaign opposed to a development project linked to US President Donald Trump's son-in-law, Jared Kushner.

Officers in riot gear clashed with youths who set up street barricades using burning trash bins. The demonstrations began over grievances with public education system.

SHIP REPORTEDLY CARRYING OVER 2,500 CONTAINERS

Ship sank after striking mine in Strait of Hormuz, says Iran

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, October 14

Iran said Wednesday that a cargo ship has sunk after hitting a naval mine in the Strait of Hormuz.

A cargo ship has sunk after hitting a naval mine in the Strait of Hormuz, Iran's Revolutionary Guard Corps navy said. It was the first time Iran has reported a ship sinking after hitting a mine during the war.

There were few details, including about the fate of the crew. State television quoted a Guard statement saying the ship was travelling on what it called an illegal and dangerous route when it hit the mine Wednesday morning. The Associated Press couldn't independently verify the images.

The unidentified ship, which was shown tilted in the water and spewing a thick plume of smoke, was carrying 2,500 containers, the broadcast said.



Representational Image

Iran has repeatedly warned ships from trying to transit through the strait without its approval. The US military has been guiding ships through the strait on a route nearer to Oman's coast.

Meanwhile, the headquarters of the Saudi state-owned oil company Aramco were hit in an overnight Houthi strike, two regional officials said, damaging the offices of the firm's chief executive and other top officials. It was the latest demonstration of the Iran-backed rebels' ability to attack high-profile targets.

There were no casualties in the attack, which the officials said targeted the top three floors of a building used by top executives in the city of Dharan. They spoke on condition of anonymity because they weren't authorised to discuss the matter with the media.

Earlier Wednesday, new explosions were heard in Riyadh, the capital of Saudi Arabia, residents said, as blame again quickly fell on Houthi rebels in neighbouring Yemen.

'Houthis struck Saudi oil giant Aramco's headquarters'

Meanwhile, new explosions were heard in Riyadh

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cairo, October 14

Two regional officials say offices belonging to senior executives with Saudi oil giant Aramco were hit in an overnight Houthi strike on the company's headquarters, in the latest demonstration of the Iran-backed rebels' ability to attack high-profile targets even after issuing warnings that they would do so.

The officials said the top three floors in a building used by top executives were damaged. One official said the office of the company's chief executive was among those hit. There were no casualties. The officials spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorised to discuss the matter with the media. The Houthis earlier said they targeted Dhahran, which hosts the headquarters, with a ballistic missile.

Earlier Wednesday, new explosions were heard in the Saudi capital, residents said, as blame again quickly fell on Iran-backed Houthi rebels in neighbouring Yemen.

A Houthi official told The Associated Press that powers including Russia and China had reached out to the rebels in search of a ceasefire deal.



KEY POINTS

- There were no casualties
- The group targeted Dhahran with ballistic missileHouthis called the latest attacks retaliation for 'treacherous Saudi aggression' in Yemen

The sight of smoke rising from some of Saudi Arabia's most sensitive facilities in recent days has rattled the region and global markets while increasing questions for President Donald Trump, who has said he is evaluating whether the US should join Saudi strikes against the Houthis.

In the latest attacks, the Saudi-led military coalition fighting the Houthis said it intercepted a ballistic missile targeting Dhahran; cruise and ballistic missiles and drones targeting the capital, Riyadh; and a cruise missile targeting Al-Kharj, home to Prince Sultan Air Base and the state-owned Military Industries Corporation.

The Houthis called the latest attacks retaliation for "treacherous Saudi aggression" against the rebel-held Yemeni capital of Sanaa and other areas. Separately, the rebel-run Health Ministry reported two dead in attacks in Yemen on Tuesday and blamed the Saudis.

Pak Parl endorses emergency in KPK

Fed govt dismissed provincial govt

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, October 14

The Parliament of Pakistan on Wednesday passed resolutions endorsing the emergency imposed in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, days after the federal government dismissed the provincial government led by jailed former prime minister Imran Khan's party.

President Asif Ali Zardari on Sunday proclaimed an emergency under Article 232 and imposed governor's rule under Article 234 of the Constitution, with the federal government accusing the Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI)-led provincial administration of failing to effectively tackle rising militancy.

Minister for Parliamentary Affairs Tariq Fazal Chaudhry tabled the motions regarding the proclamation of emergency before both Houses of Parliament.

The National Assembly (NA) adopted the resolution by a majority vote following a discussion opened by Law Minister.

"The National Assembly approves the Proclamation of Emergency issued by the President on the 11th October, 2026 in the Province of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa under the second proviso of clause (1) of Article 232 of the Constitution," the NA said in a post on X.

Under Article 232, if the president acts on his own, a proclamation of emergency must be placed before both Houses of Parliament for approval within 10 days.

UK study visa refusals impact university offers for foreign students: Report

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
London, October 14

International students, including Indians, are likely to be impacted as British universities revoke offers to courses amid a clampdown on study visas issued by the UK Home Office, according to a media analysis this week.

The Financial Times newspaper analysed official data to find that universities are taking the step to withdraw offers to students over fears of facing a blanket ban on their ability to recruit foreign students.

Under the Home Office rules, education institutions where more than 5 per cent of prospective international students given offers subsequently have their visa applications rejected face the risk of being banned from recruiting them.



Representational Image

THIS TIGHTENING OF THE PREVIOUS 10% THRESHOLD IS AIMED AT WHAT THE UK GOVT BELIEVES IS THE ABUSE OF THE STUDENT VISA ROUTE BY CERTAIN NATIONALITIES, LED BY PAKISTANIS AND NIGERIANS

This tightening of the previous 10 per cent threshold is aimed at what the UK government believes is the abuse of the student visa route by certain nationalities, led by Pakistanis and Nigerians.

"Many refusals appear to rest on flawed, inconsistent and highly subjective reasoning, forcing universities to withdraw offers at scale to avoid breaching compliance thresholds," said Jamie Arrowsmith, director of Universities UK International (UUKi) -- which represents institutions recruiting abroad.

While acknowledging the need to maintain confidence in the immigration system, he stressed that "visa processing has become markedly less predictable".

The Financial Times said its analysis of Home Office data showed that in the first half of this year, 10.5 per cent of study visa applications to the UK ended up being withdrawn, up from 2.3 per cent in the same period last year and 0.4 per cent in 2023.

'Russia keeps striking Ukraine's energy sites'

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, October 14

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy voiced outrage Wednesday over Russia's continuing aerial bombardment of Ukraine's energy infrastructure in apparent defiance of US President Donald Trump's demand for a ceasefire.

Moscow's forces pounded Ukraine's power grid, as well as oil and gas facilities, for the third straight night, Zelenskyy said, after Trump claimed that Russia and Ukraine had agreed to an "energy ceasefire" 4.5 years after Moscow's forces invaded.

Zelenskyy, meanwhile, has agreed to halt Ukraine's monthslong campaign targeting Russian oil refineries that caused fuel shortages for Russians.

Ukraine's last reported hit on an oil refinery was last Friday. The Kremlin has not confirmed that Moscow signed off on the truce, with a spokesman saying only that "contacts on this matter continue."

Ukrainian officials say they are pushing back Russian forces in eastern Ukraine, which Russia's bigger army has been trying to capture for years.

Fuel crisis hits Indonesia's Bali, triggers long lines for 6 days

The lines have been reported since Sunday

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Denpasar, October 14

Long lines of vehicles snaked outside gas stations across Indonesia's resort island of Bali this week after fuel deliveries were disrupted by a combination of technical problems, bad weather and surging demand, officials said Wednesday.

On the tourism-dependent island, motorcycles and cars waited outside stations and spilt onto nearby roads as motorists scrambled for fuel.

The lines have been reported since Sunday.



THE SHORTAGES HAVE FRUSTRATED RESIDENTS AND BUSINESS OWNERS ON THE RESORT ISLAND, WHERE TRANSPORTATION IS CRITICAL FOR DAILY LIFE AND TOURISM

Officials stressed that the shortages were caused by domestic distribution problems rather than a lack of fuel supplies or turmoil in global energy markets.

"This is purely a distribution issue," said Laode Sulaeman, director-general of oil and gas at the Energy and Mineral Resources Ministry.

"A fuel tanker was delayed, but it has now arrived, and 24-hour deliveries have been underway since yesterday."

Sulaeman said that a tanker carrying fuel to Bali suffered an anchor problem while preparing to unload cargo, delaying deliveries to the island's main fuel terminals.

Rough seas and bad weather also slowed shipments to the Sanggaran terminal in Denpasar and the Manggis terminal in eastern Bali.

The disruption was compounded by strong demand for government-subsidised Pertalite gasoline, which is significantly cheaper than nonsubsidised fuel.

Panic-buying by motorists worried about shortages further strained supplies at some stations.

At several gas stations, attendants posted signs reading, "Sorry, no fuel available," while drivers and motorcyclists waited outside closed facilities for new deliveries.

News at a glance

Rupee rises 19 paise to 95.17 against US dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee appreciated 19 paise to close at 95.17 against the US dollar on Wednesday, registering the fourth straight session of gain, supported by Reserve Bank of India interventions designed to ease near-term dollar demand and limit speculative foreign exchange exposure.

Forex traders said the Indian rupee rose to a one-month high on RBI's measures to curb speculative bets. A weak dollar and easing of US Treasury yields also aided the rupee. However, weak domestic markets capped sharp gains.

SBIFML appoints RS Srinivas Jain as Joint CEO

NEW DELHI: SBI Funds Management Limited (SBIFML) has appointed R.S. Srinivas Jain as Joint Chief Executive Officer (CEO) and Key Managerial Personnel (KMP), with effect from 13 October 2026. The company's board approved the appointment following a recommendation from the Nomination and Remuneration Committee.

Jain brings more than 34 years of experience in the banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI) sector, including 27 years in the mutual fund industry.



Union MoS BL Verma, MoS Nimuben Jayantibhai Bambhaniya, Secretary Nidhi Khare, and BIS DG Sanjay Garg during the World Standards Day event in New Delhi

Chandigarh: BIS celebrates World Standards Day

CHANDIGARH: The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), Northern Regional Office, Chandigarh, celebrated World Standards Day 2026 on the theme "Shared Vision for a Better World – SDG 7: Affordable and Clean Energy". Haryana Minister Rajesh Nagar, the chief guest, stressed the importance of quality standards in promoting sustainable development, economic growth and consumer confidence. BIS Northern Regional Office Deputy Director General Deepak Kumar Singla called for building a quality-driven culture to support the Viksit Bharat 2047 vision.

PRICES OF FOOD, FUEL, MANUFACTURED ITEMS RISE

WPI inflation rises to 11.39% in Sept

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 14

India's wholesale price-based inflation rose to 11.39 per cent in September, compared to 9.92 per cent in August, on rising prices of food, manufactured items, and fuel and power, government data showed on Wednesday. Inflation in the food index rose to 8.66 per cent in September from 7.05 per cent in August.

In manufactured items, WPI inflation was at a series high of 9.76 per cent, higher than 8.37 per cent in August.

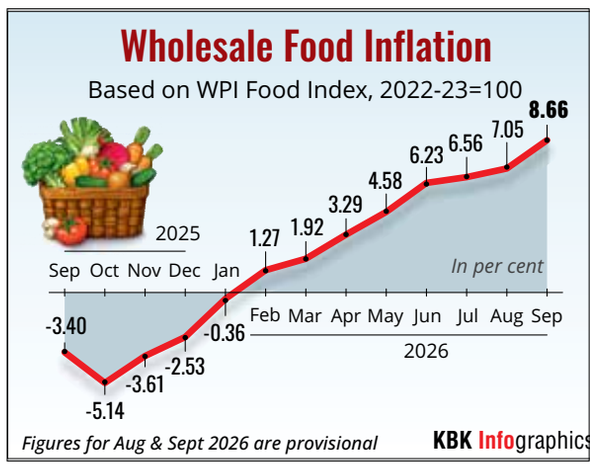
In the fuel and power basket, Wholesale Price Index (WPI)-based inflation was 25.85 per cent in September, compared to 22.93 per cent in the previous month.

Across groups, mineral oils (containing petroleum products), food articles, crude petroleum & natural gas, coal and lignite, manufacture of basic metals, chemicals and chemical products, textiles, rubber and plastic products and electrical equipments have been drivers of WPI inflation in September 2026, the Commerce and Industry ministry said while releasing the WPI data.

The WPI has been on an upward trajectory since the beginning of this fiscal year as the West Asia war and the resultant blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, through which the majority of crude oil is imported into India, pushed up global crude and fertiliser costs with a spillover effect on food and commodity prices.

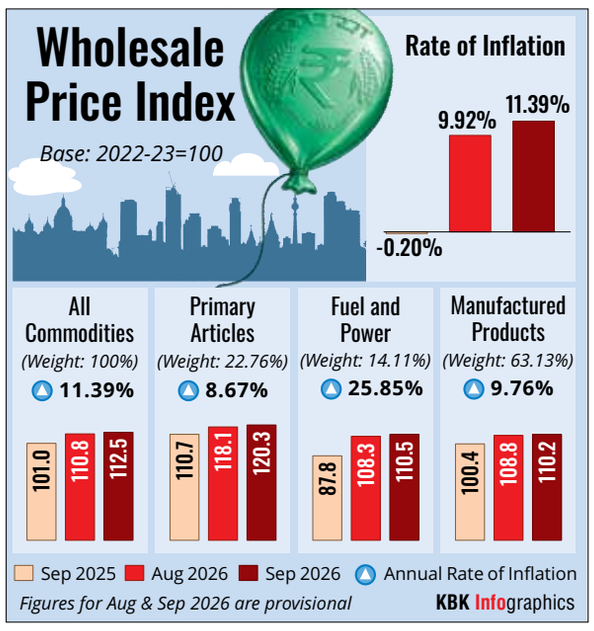
The Reserve Bank of India's monetary policy committee, last week hiked benchmark policy rates by 25 bps to 5.50 per cent.

Retail inflation data released earlier this week showed inflation rose to a 23-month high of 5.54 per cent in September, from 4.83 per cent in August, driven by a sharp rise in food prices.



HIGHLIGHTS

- Inflation in the food index rose to 8.66% in Sept from 7.05% in Aug
- In manufactured items, inflation was at a series high of 9.76%, higher than 8.37% in Aug
- In the fuel and power basket, WPI-based inflation was 25.85% in Sept, compared to 22.93% in the previous month



India's trade deficit with China crosses $100 bn in first 9-month

Total bilateral trade increases by 25.4% to $144.45 billion

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 14

India's trade deficit with China crossed USD 100 billion in the first nine months of this year, even as Indian exports grew by 40.7 per cent, sustaining their upward momentum amid a continued surge in Chinese exports.

India's trade deficit with China widened to USD 105.93 billion, up 20.7 per cent compared to last year, according to data released by China's General Administration of Customs on Wednesday.

The total bilateral trade increased by 25.4 per cent to USD 144.45 billion between January and September, according to the data.

China's exports to India touched USD 125.19 billion, registering a 23.3 per cent increase. Indian exports to China registered a 40.7 per cent increase, touching USD 19.26 billion, compared to the same period last year.

China's exports are dominated by electronics, machinery and chemicals catering to India's manufacturing base.

India's exports to China are made up of a mix of primary and resource products like ores, fuels, seafood and agricultural items, according to data.

China's trade data is compiled from January to December, while India's figures are calculated on a financial year basis from April to March.

According to India's Commerce Ministry, bilateral trade reached USD 151.1 billion last year.

India's exports to China rose 36.66 per cent to USD 19.47 billion during the last fiscal year, while imports increased 16 per cent to USD 131.63 billion.



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

INSIGHT

- China's exports are dominated by electronics, machinery and chemicals catering to India's manufacturing base
- India's exports to China are made up of a mix of primary and resource products like ores, fuels, seafood and agricultural items
- China's trade data is compiled from January to December, while India's figures are calculated on a financial year basis from April to March

World Bank helps mobilise $36 bn in private capital in India since FY22

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 14

The World Bank Group has helped mobilise USD 36 billion over the past four years for development across sectors, including efforts to boost investment and create jobs, with USD 9.6 billion channelled towards micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs).

Private capital mobilisation by the group has grown nearly five-fold, from around USD 3 billion in FY22 to USD 14.5 billion in FY26, Manuel Reyes-Retana, Division Director, South Asia, International Finance Corporation (IFC), said.

He said guarantees provided by the IFC and the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA) were attracting institutional investors familiar with the World Bank Group's underwriting standards and governance practices.

The group connects government development priorities with private investment by strengthening markets, structuring viable projects and reducing risks through financing, guarantees and partnerships.

Under the USD 436-million Raising and Accelerating MSME Performance (RAMP) programme, the World Bank supported reforms to the Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS), a digital platform that helps businesses convert unpaid invoices into cash. The initiative has enabled more than 2.5 lakh MSMEs to access capital faster, with 30 non-banking financial companies joining the platform.

Stock mkts close lower

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 14

Benchmark stock indices Sensex and Nifty closed lower on Wednesday amid profit-taking after a sharp rally in the previous session, as a spike in wholesale price-based inflation and firm crude oil prices hit investor sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex declined 251.89 points, or 0.34 per cent, to settle at 72,781.89. During the day, it hit a high of 73,195.26 and a low of 72,578.75.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 99.25 points, or 0.44 per cent, to end at 22,622.70.

From the 30 Sensex firms, Bajaj Finance, Mahindra & Mahindra, Bajaj Finserv, Eternal, ICICI Bank and InterGlobe Aviation were among the major laggards.

Infosys, Tech Mahindra, Tata Consultancy Services, Hindustan Unilever, NTPC and Reliance Industries were among the major gainers.

Broader markets also declined as the BSE SmallCap Select index fell 0.72 per cent and the MidCap Select index by 0.14 per cent.

Among BSE sectoral indices, Housing Finance tanked 1.12 per cent, Insurance 1.04 per cent, Healthcare 0.93 per cent, Auto 0.87 per cent, Hospitals 0.82 per cent, Realty 0.80 per cent and Telecommunication 0.73 per cent.

Utilities jumped 2.07 per cent, Power 1.74 per cent, IT 1.41 per cent, Energy 1.28 per cent, FMCG 1.14 per cent and Focused IT 1.10 per cent.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, was up 0.36 per cent to USD 106.1 per barrel.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 1,305.13 crore on Tuesday, according to exchange data.

'Clean energy must be affordable'

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 14

ENERGY TRANSITION SHOULD NOT INCREASE COSTS FOR HOUSEHOLDS OR SLOW INDUSTRIAL GROWTH: ADANI

Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani has said India's energy transition must balance decarbonisation with affordable and reliable power, warning that a shift to clean energy should not increase costs for households or slow industrial growth.

In a LinkedIn post on Wednesday following his meeting with Michael Bloomberg in New Delhi, Adani said the transition would depend on making clean energy economically viable while expanding the infrastructure needed to support India's development.

"Decarbonisation cannot be an ideological decree that prices out ordinary citizens, shuts down factories or stalls the Global South," he wrote.

Adani said clean energy must become a reliable and affordable option for households and businesses for the transition to succeed. He cited the need to reduce the additional cost of adopting green energy, while cautioning against continued dependence on existing energy systems amid climate volatility.

"Real progress demands that capital, policy and execution lock arms to drive down the green premium until clean power is undeniably the cheaper, superior choice," he said.

The Adani Group chairman also highlighted the need for India to expand its power supply, industrial capacity and digital access to support economic development and improve living standards.

He said the infrastructure required for long-term growth extends beyond physical assets such as ports, transmission corridors, green hydrogen plants and computing facilities. Reliable data, accountable institutions and effective governance are equally important, he added.

"True nation-building demands four non-negotiable forces, namely patient capital, physical execution, transparent governance and capable local leadership," he said.

The meeting with Bloomberg also covered urban development, artificial intelligence, advanced manufacturing and green infrastructure. Adani referred to the Dharavi redevelopment project in Mumbai, saying its success should be assessed by improvements in residents' living conditions and livelihoods rather than the amount of real estate developed.

OFFER TO OPEN ON OCT 21

Jio Platforms files final IPO prospectus

MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, October 14



FILE PIC

Jio Platforms Ltd (JPL), the digital and telecom arm of Reliance Industries, filed its red herring prospectus on Wednesday for an initial public offering that is widely expected to be India's largest, Reliance said in a filing.

The IPO is a fresh issue of up to 27 crore equity shares of Rs 10 face value each. The offer opens for subscription on Wednesday, October 21, and closes on Friday, October 23. Anchor investor bidding is on Monday, October 19.

While the filing did not give a price band, reports suggest the company may be eyeing to raise about Rs 30,000 crore.

The shares are expected to list on October 28.

The issue includes two reserved portions - up to Rs 500 crore for eligible JPL employees and up to Rs 2,500 crore for eligible Reliance shareholders, according to the filing.

These are individuals and Hindu undivided families (HUFs) who hold Reliance shares as of October 14.

According to the draft prospectus filed in June, JPL's consolidated revenue from operations rose 14.6 per cent to Rs 1,46,885 crore in the year to March 2026, from Rs 1,28,218 crore a year earlier.

Its net profit climbed 15.1 per cent to Rs 30,049 crore from Rs 26,109 crore rupees. Revenue was Rs 1,09,558 crore in FY24, with profit of Rs 21,423 crore.

The company's EBITDA rose 18.8 per cent to Rs 76,255 crore, a margin of 51.91 per cent. It had more than 524 million subscribers, and average revenue per user (ARPU) was Rs 214 in the March 2026 quarter.

The total borrowings fell 3.1 per cent year-on-year to Rs 70,781 crore, though return on capital employed slipped to 10.76 per cent.

The draft prospectus had said proceeds would be used to prepay certain borrowings of material subsidiary Reliance Jio Infocomm (RJIL) and for general corporate purposes. Because the offer is entirely a fresh issue, the money goes to the company and not to selling shareholders.

The draft prospectus had flagged heavy dependence on the promoter group.

Reliance Retail is the sole distributor of Jio's prepaid services, and pre-paid revenue through it made up 77.08 per cent of consolidated revenue from operations in FY26.

JPL filed its draft prospectus on June 19. Reliance held 66.43 per cent of JPL before the IPO. Meta and Google together hold about 17.7 per cent.

The issue has 19 book-running lead managers, including Kotak Mahindra Capital, Morgan Stanley, BofA Securities, Goldman Sachs and JP Morgan, with KFin Technologies as registrar.

India's steel demand to grow fastest: WSA

India's YoY steel demand growth rate pegged at 7.9% in 2026

SURYA SARATHI RAY
New Delhi, October 14

India's steel demand is expected to grow the fastest among major consuming nations in both 2026 and 2027, driven by higher demand in construction, real estate, manufacturing, renewable energy, and other sectors.

In its recent short-range outlook, the World Steel Association (WSA) has pegged India's year-on-year steel demand growth rate at 7.9% in 2026. This will rise slightly to 8% in 2027.

India is the world's second-largest steel-producing and consuming nation after China. Steel consumption strongly correlates with a country's economic growth. The International Monetary Fund (IMF) has recently raised India's GDP growth forecast to 7% for 2026 and 2027, up from 6.4% forecast in July.

WSA is one of the largest associations of steel makers globally. Its members represent around 85% of the global steel production.

"India remains the world's fastest-growing major steel market. Growth continues to be broad-based. Infrastructure-led construction remains the primary driver. Private real estate demand is robust. Healthy manufacturing growth, a substantial renewable energy project pipeline and continued expansion of manufacturing capacity are lifting both electrical and mechanical machinery, while automotive output is buoyed by domestic demand, export momentum and policy support," WSA said.

Steel demand in China, the world's biggest market, is expected to contract by 2.0% in 2026. However, in 2027, the contraction is expected to narrow to 1.0%.

Finished steel demand growth forecast (Y-o-Y; in %)

	2025	2026(f)	2027(f)
China	(-) 7.1	(-) 2	(-) 1
India	8.1	7.9	8
US	2	2	1.5
Japan	(-) 3.4	0.9	1.7
S Korea	(-) 8.9	1.8	1.3

(f-forecast; Source: WSA)

MESSI BOULI STRIKES LATE

Punjab FC edge Odisha FC in ISL

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 14



Punjab FC began their Indian Super League 2026-27 campaign with a dramatic 2-1 victory over Odisha FC here on Wednesday, as Messi Bouli scored a stoppage-time winner in the 90+5th minute after the sides went into half-time level at 1-1.

The Shers made a flying start, taking the lead inside the opening minute. Muhammed Uvais delivered a cross into the box, which Messi Bouli converted with a right-footed finish into the bottom-right corner to give Punjab FC an early advantage.

The Juggernauts responded in the 15th minute through a set-piece opportunity. Lalthathanga Khawlhring delivered a cross from a corner, which Thoiba Moirangthem met with a header into the bottom-right corner to bring Odisha FC level at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium.

Both sides continued to create chances in the first half. Alfred Planas tested Odisha FC goalkeeper Hrithik Tiwari, but the custodian kept the scores level.

At the other end, Mahmoud Eid missed an opportunity from inside the box in the 18th minute.

Ricky Shabong and Bijoy Varghese also came close for Punjab FC, while Stephen Eze tried his luck from distance in first-half stoppage time.

The contest remained evenly poised after the restart, with both teams looking for a breakthrough. Giorgi Aburjania came close for Odisha FC in the 46th minute, sending an effort from inside the box just over the crossbar.

Messi then missed the target in the 51st minute following a cross from Alfred Planas.

Punjab FC stepped up their attacking efforts as the half progressed. Planas sent an effort over the crossbar in the 56th minute before Hrithik Tiwari produced a save to deny Diego Raposo two minutes later.

Bijoy Varghese also went close with a header from Khaiminthang Lhungdim's cross following a corner in the 61st minute, but his effort narrowly missed the target.

Odisha FC introduced Éverton Nascimento and Lalrinfela Khiangte in the 64th minute as they looked to take control of the contest. The Juggernauts threatened through a series of set-pieces late in the game, with Rahim Ali and Stephen Eze attempting headers around the 80th minute.

Mahmoud Eid also tested Punjab FC goalkeeper Arshdeep Singh from outside the box, but the custodian made the save.

The Shers continued to push for a winner in the closing stages. Vishal Yadav sent an effort wide in the 82nd minute before Hrithik Tiwari denied substitute Gurkirat Singh in the 85th minute.

Muhammed Uvais then came close with a long-range attempt in the 86th minute, but his effort went narrowly wide.

With five minutes of added time, Odisha threatened at one end as Suhair VP sent an effort wide before Arshdeep Singh saved Nihal Sudheesh's attempt from outside the box in the 90+5th minute.

Punjab FC responded immediately, with Vishal Yadav setting up Messi inside the box. The forward finished with his left foot to restore the Shers' lead and seal a dramatic 2-1 win.

KEY POINTS

- The Shers made a flying start, taking the lead inside the opening minute
- Both sides continued to create chances in the first half
- At the other end, Mahmoud Eid missed an opportunity from inside the box in the 18th minute
- Punjab FC stepped up their attacking efforts as the half progressed

MCC relays Lord's pitch after ICC demerit point

ASSOCIATED PRESS
London, October 14

The Marylebone Cricket Club (MCC) has relaid the Lord's pitch that received an "unsatisfactory" rating from the ICC following England's Test against New Zealand in June, with the surface set to remain out of use for at least the next two seasons.

Pitch 9, one of five central strips at the iconic venue used for international matches, was handed its first-ever demerit point by the ICC after match referee Andy Pycroft found excessive seam movement and inconsistent bounce during the Test.

The match saw all 40 wickets fall in just 166 overs, with 24 dismissals coming through either bowled or leg-before-wicket decisions.

The MCC chair Mark Nicholas had announced a seven-point action plan following the match, prompting the club's director of cricket and operations Rob Lynch and the groundstaff to undertake a comprehensive review of pitch preparation, according to a report in ESPNcricinfo.

The club has also sought expert advice and commissioned data analysis as part of the exercise, which Nicholas described as the most extensive review of Lord's square and pitch preparation in a generation.

Kakatiya Knights, Mighty Marathas stay clear at top

Prithviraaj Yodhas bounce back in APL



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Hyderabad, October 14

Kakatiya Knights and Mighty Marathas stayed clear at the top of the standings as they beat Rajputana Royals and Chola Chiefs, respectively, in Archery Premier League Season 2 here on Wednesday.

Earlier in the day, Prithviraaj Yodhas downed Chero Archers to move into third place with eight points.

In the final match of the day, Chiefs' woeful run of form continued as they remained rooted to the bottom of the table with just one win in seven matches, suffering a fifth straight defeat.

In complete contrast, Marathas, who had started the season with two losses, have now won five on the trot and appear to be the team to beat.

The last time Prithviraaj Yodhas and Chero Archers met, three sudden-death tiebreakers were needed to decide a winner.

But in the reverse fixture, Yodhas made light work of Chero Archers and registered a convincing 5-1.

Yodhas were led by some superb shooting by 16-year-old recurve archer Gatha Anandrao Khadake, who shot 58 out of a possible 60, and Asian Games compound medallist Ganesh Thirumuru (59).

With this win, Yodhas has arrested their own mini slump while Chero Archers – who had started the season brightly – have now suffered three straight defeats.

Carrying on from where they left off in their previous meeting, it appeared as though there would be very little to separate Yodhas and Chero as they tied the first set 75-75.

But the second set would slip away from Chero as Kumkum Moho was left with little time to shoot the final arrow and she could manage only a 7, while Yodhas finished the set strongly with four 10s.

BFI Prez, secretary general suspend each other amid power struggle

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 14

The power struggle in the Boxing Federation of India intensified on Wednesday with president Ajay Singh and secretary general Pramod Kumar suspending each other, both alleging violations of the federation's constitution.

Singh suspended Kumar on Tuesday pending an inquiry into alleged financial irregularities, non-cooperation with investigations and misuse of authority.

On Wednesday, Kumar issued a counter-order suspending Singh pending the outcome of a no-confidence motion, which he had planned to move during a Special General Meeting (SGM) on October 28.

He had claimed the support of a majority of affiliated state units to move the no-confidence motion.

KEY POINTS

- Singh suspended Kumar on Tuesday pending an inquiry into alleged financial irregularities
- Kumar accused Singh of continuing to exercise executive control over the federation

Kumar accused Singh of continuing to exercise executive control over the federation despite being served a cease-and-desist notice on October 8.

"You are hereby placed under interim suspension from the office of Secretary General with immediate effect, pending completion of the inquiry or until the order is modified or revoked by the competent authority, subject to the applicable provisions of the BFI Constitution," read the order against Kumar, in possession of PTI.

The order, however, clarified that the suspension was an interim measure and "shall not be construed as a final determination of the allegations".

In his order, Singh also accused Kumar failing to cooperate with an inquiry into the cancellation of a national championship and attempting to convene an unauthorised meeting to move a no-confidence motion against the president.

In the BFI order, Singh alleged that the federation had received notices from Pinnacle Broadcast Productions seeking approximately Rs 1.5 crore for broadcasting undertaken at the World Boxing Finals Cup in Greater Noida in November last year.

Kumar, in an earlier letter to the president, had stated that Pinnacle committed Rs two crore towards sponsorship and broadcasting of the event.

Satwik-Chirag crash out of Denmark Open

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Odense, October 14

The men's doubles pair of Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty, as well as Unnati Hooda and Ayush Shetty in women's and men's singles, crashed out of the Denmark Open badminton tournament here on Wednesday.

The world No. 5 Indian pairing of Satwik and Chirag went down 21-12, 15-21, 19-21 to the world No. 37 Chinese duo of He Ji Ting and Ren Xiang Yu in their round of 32 contest which lasted exactly an hour.

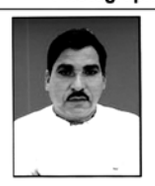
In the men's singles round of 32 match, Shetty lost to Indonesia's Alwi Farhan 11-21, 21-13, 10-21.

ZONAL HEADQUARTERS CRIME BRANCH EOW JAMMU
e-Mail ID: sspcrimejmu@jkpolice.gov.in

LOOK OUT NOTICE

The Public in general is hereby informed through the medium of this **LOOK OUT NOTICE** that the present whereabouts of the below mentioned person is required for the purpose of investigation of case **FIR No. 04/2026** U/S 420, 120-B IPC registered at Police Station EOW, Crime Branch Jammu.

The photograph and Description roll of the absconding person is as under:-

Description Role	Photograph
Name: Romesh **Parentage:** Mangho Ram **R/O:** Village Fangtoli Tehsil & District Pathankot, Punjab. **Age:** 55 years (approx) **Height:** 5 Ft.8 Inch Approx. **Built:** Strong **Complexion:** Fair	

It is therefore requested that have sharp look in their respective jurisdictions, if traced or any clue leading to the above mentioned absconding persons,involved in the above mentioned case, struck out, immediate information may kindly be sent to the web site E-mail ID sspcrimejmu@jkpolice.gov.in (EOW Crime Branch Jammu) Phone no 7006087177

Sr. Superintendent of Police
EOW
Crime Branch Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-12411/26

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

"PUBLIC NOTIFICATION"

Notice is given to all user of Railway line and premises situated on the completed section of Hathras Station of North Central Railway, 2x25 kV Hathras/SSP will be energized on or after 19/10/2026 in the following section around the railway line. On or from this date the overhead line will at all times be treated as a live line and no unauthorized person shall approach or work in the proximity of the said overhead line.

Date of Energization : 19.10.2026

Section	KM/Location/Chainage	
	From	To
Enerzisation of New 2x25 kv Hathras/SSP in connection with raising of speed to 160 Kmph/200 Kmph. Design, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of 132/2x25 kV Traction Sub-station along with SP/SSPs between Ghaziabad- Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyay on existing New Delhi-Howrah Route of North Central Railway	Hathras/ SSP Km. 1296/35 (CH.1296/862.60)	Hathras/ SSP Km. 1296/37 (CH 1296/912.60)

2350/26 (MG) Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/project, NCR, Kanpur

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

HIMACHAL PRADESH
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Bhoranj Division HPPWD, Bhoranj on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the Item rate/ Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed below on the table:-

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated cost (In Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Starting date for down-loading Bid	Deadline for submission of Bid
1	Restoration / Repair on Una Aghar Mandi road km 79/000 to 91/00 (SH:- P/L 30 mm thick BC in km. 86/00 to 88/450 & 88/530 to 89/00 & GSB km 79/180 to 79/250 , Cement concrete pavement at Km 79/150 to 79/270, 88/450 to 88/530) (under PDNA 2025 Sr. No. 1986)	1,31,94,393/-	264000/-	16-10-2026	23-10-2024

The bidders are advised to note all details of tenders, from the department website .

Executive Engineer
Bhoranj Division , HPPWD Bhoranj, Pin Code 176045
Tel. No. 01972-266099 e-mail : eepwd-bhoranj-hp@gov.in

Ro.No 4116/2026-2027 HIM SUCHANA AVAM JAN SAMPARK on behalf of Governor of HP

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 26/48 Dt. 13.10.2026

E-PROCUREMENT TENER NOTICE

On behalf of the president of India, **The Principal Chief Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj, (An ISO 9001:2015 certified unit)** invites the following E-Procurement Tenders.

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Tender Opening Date
1	70263502	PAINT ENAMEL GENTIAN BLUE	124973 Ltr.	10.11.2026
2	70262680	DECORATIVE THERMOSETTING SYNTHETIC RESIN	25897 Nos.	10.11.2026
3	70263044	ELECTRODE HOLDER TYPE A-600 AMPS	13862 Nos.	10.11.2026
4	6326RGC07A	This is tender to enter into Running Contract for Manufacture and Supply of PSC Sleeper of different RDSO Drawing nos. T-4865, T-4218, T-6068 & T-8970.	26855.40 Set.	16-NOV-26
5	6326RGC18	This is tender to enter into Running Contract for Manufacturing & supply of HVN-66 Insulating Liner for use with wider PSC Sleeper to Drawing No. RDSO/T-8746 Suitable for 60Kg (UIC)/60E1 & 52 Kg Rails (Applicable for Drawing No. RT-8751) DRG: (RDSO) RT 8751-53.	7763217.00 Numbers	25-NOV-26
6	38262870	PU Lining (Top & Bottom) of CCPU Side Bearer Pad Assembly)	44636 Set	30.10.2026
7	38264244	Round Head Lock Bolt-22.22 mm Dia, Grip Range-31.75 mm to 38.10 mm	296197 Pairs	12.11.2026
8	6326RGC15	This is tender to enter into Running Contract for Manufacture and supply of 6.2 mm thick Composite grooved rubber sole plates for placing beneath C.I. chari of SEJ (T-6902) on concrete sleeper conforming to RDSO Drawing No. T-10346.	4914.00 Set.	10-NOV-26
9	6326RGC09A	This is tender to enter into Running Contract for Manufacture and supply of Nylon Cord reinforced GRSP for 1 in 12 and 1 in 8.5 Turnout with ORCS.	5317.00 Set.	02-NOV-26
10	30262643	STAINLESS STEEL WASH BASIN	1348 NOS.	03.11.2026
11	40263188	Set of 120 AH VRLA Batteries	473 SET.	02.11.2026
12	20263467	Oil Coller Radiator for Converter / Transformer	22 NOS.	05.11.2026
13	40261323	BLDC FAN	4353 Nos.	12.11.2026

Note: The complete information of above tenders can be seen and downloaded from **IREPS** website i.e. **https://www.ireps.gov.in**. Fory any change/corrigendum in tender, please visit this website regulary. 2331/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Jharkhand Education Project Council
J.S.C.A Stadium Road, Jagannathpur, Sector -3,
Dhurwa, Ranchi - 834004 Phone - 0651-2444502 E-mail: jepcranchi1@gmail.com

Tender Notice
E-Tender for Printing and supply of textbooks for the academic year 2027-28
Class IX to XII
Tender No: MRE/33/313/2026-27/4090

Jharkhand Education Project Council (JEPC), Ranchi invites e-bids in two bids system (Technical & Financial) from reputed and eligible printers for the printing and supply of textbooks for class 9 to 12 for the academic year 2027-28. Important dates/details are as under:

Sl. No.	Activity	Start Date	Time	End Date	Time
1	Online availability of bid document	15.10.2026	11.00 am	05.11.2026	03.00 pm
2	Pre-Bid Meeting	22.10.2026	03.00 pm	-	-
3	**Online Bid Submission**	15.10.2026	11.00 am	05.11.2026	03.00 pm
4	Submission of Paper sample	05.11.2026	11.00 am	06.11.2026	01.00 pm
5	Opening of Technical Bid	06.11.2026	03.00 pm	-	-

Interested bidders may view and download bid documents from the website http://jharkhand tenders.gov.in.

Sd/-
(Shashi Ranjan)
State Project Director

PR.NO.391807 Jharkhand Education Project Council(26-27):D

Government of Jharkhand
District Engineer, District Board, Simdega.

e-Procurement Tender NoticeNo.01SBD/2026-27
NITNo.-01SBD/2026-27 Date :-14.10.2026

1.	Name of the work	CONSTRUCTION OF PROPOSED MODEL ZILA PARISHAD OFFICE BUILDING, SIMDEGA, JHARKHAND.
2.	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs.**8,01,13,200.00**
3.	T ender Fee and Bid Security	Tender document fee:-INR10000/- (Rupees Ten Thousand Only) Non-Refundable. Bid Security: Rs**1605000.00**(Rupees sixteen Lakh five thousand Only).
4.	Time of Completion	24month
5.	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	23.10.2026at 11:00AM
6.	Start Date of Submission of Bids	23.10.2026(Online)at 11:00AM
8.	Pre Bid Meeting	04.11.2026at 01:30PM
9.	Last Date/Time for receipt of bids Online	19.11.2026(Online)till0 3:00PM
10.	Date andTime of Technical Bid Opening Online.	21.11.2026(Online)from 03:30PM
11.	Name & address of office Inviting tender	**District Engineer, District Board, Simdega Address:Zila Parisad Office Simdega.**
12.	Helpline number of e-Procurement cell	**8083010040**
13.	e-mailid	**simdegazp@gmail.com**

NOTE :-(i) cost of bidding Document (not refundable) & Bid Security (Security Deposit) Shall be payable online through http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.
(ii) Any Change/Information can be seen on Website on http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.
(iii) Any other Information can be seen on Website on http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.

District Engineer,
District Board, Simdega.

PR.NO.391760 Simdega(26-27):D

झारखण्ड सरकार
स्वास्थ्य, चिकित्सा शिक्षा एवं परिवार कल्याण विभाग
प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

राज्य के सरकारी चिकित्सा महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न विभागों में शैक्षणिक संवर्ग के सह–प्राध्यापक के रिक्त पदों पर संविदा के आधार पर सेवाएँ प्राप्त करने हेतु प्रकाशित विज्ञापन सं०– PR389808 Health Med Edu Family Welfare (26–27)D के अंतर्गत दिनांक–21.09.2026 को रिम्स के प्रशासनिक भवन में आयोजित Walk In Interview को अपरिहार्य कारणों से रद्द किया जाता है

निदेशक, चिकित्सा शिक्षा
झारखंड राँची

PR 391735 Health Med Edu and Family Welfare(26-27)D

UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 945 **TENDER NOTICE** Date: 14.10.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil-II) SHP, Maneri, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No.: 04/EE(Civil-II)/SHP/Maneri/2026-27
Name of work: Seepage Rectification Work in Power Channel at Pilangad (2×1125 kW) SHP, District Uttarkashi.
Estimated cost: Rs 12,49,788.00 (Excluding GST)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 16-10-2026 from 17:00 hrs.
Date for submission of Tender: 16-11-2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **www.ujvnl.com**

Executive Engineer (Civil-II), SHP, Maneri. Uttarkashi.

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Neeraj Tiwari S/o:** Lt. Sh. Ashok Kumar Tiwari **R/o:** Surender Ka Makan Transformer Wali Gali Najafgarh Park Road, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CR/CT CASE No. 10207/2019, FIR No. 015795/2019, U/S: 411/34 IPC, PS: Hari Nagar, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Neeraj Tiwari,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Neeraj Tiwari,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Neeraj Tiwari** of **CR/CT CASE No. 10207/2019, FIR No. 015795/2019, U/S: 411/34 IPC, PS: Hari Nagar, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.11.2026**.

By Order
Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II
West Court No. 206
Tis Hazari Court, New Delhi

DP/14577/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Pawan S/o** Tau Ram **R/o:** A-5, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi-39 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No: 474/2019 U/s: 411 IPC, PS: Bawana, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Pawan ,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Pawan ,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Pawan,** of **FIR No: 474/2019 U/s: 411 IPC, PS: Bawana, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.12.2026**.

By Order
Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Court Room No. 114 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/14290/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

Bharat Coking Coal Limited
(A Mini Ratna Comnany)
(A Subsidiary of Coal India Limited)

NOTICE

All the tenders issued by Bharat Coking Coal Limited (B.C.C.L.) for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on website of **B.C.C.L. "www.bcclweb.in"** Coal India Limited (CIL) e-procurement portal **"https://coalindiatenders.nic.in"** and Central Public Procurement Portal **"https://eprocure.gov.in"** In addition, procurement is also done through GeM portal **"https://gem.gov.in".** This is applicable to all Open (Domestic / Global) Tenders issued through e-procurement portal of CIL.

This information is also available on BCCL website www.bcclweb.in

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PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office: PSEB, Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate Identity Number:U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in
Mobile No. 96461-55525

E-Tender Enq. No. 7879/P-3/EMP-13452 dated 12.10.2026

Dy. Chief Engineer/ Headquarter (Procurement Cell-3) GGSSTP Roopnagar invites E-Tender ID No. 2026_POWER_177375_1 for procurement of msn tank for storage of HCL acid in DM plant stage-III at GGGSSTP Rupnagar.
For detailed NIT & Tender Specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 12 10 2026 / 5:00 PM onwards onwards.
Note: - Corrigendum & addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

RTP-100/26 PR-Advt. No :- :- 1079/12/2026-27/16172

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Ravi Kumar @ Sonu S/o** Manohar Lal **R/o** Kh. No. 174, Rithala Village, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 87/2021, U/S 411 IPC, PS South Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ravi Kumar @ Sonu** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ravi Kumar @ Sonu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Ravi Kumar @ Sonu** the said accused of **FIR No. 87/2021, U/S 411 IPC, PS South Rohini, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Gaurav Katariya
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
(North-West), Court No.-208,
2nd Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/14646/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Ravinder Singh** Prop. of **True Travels R/o** B-4/90B, Lawrence Road, Keshavpuram, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 1498/2023, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Shalimar Bagh, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ravinder Singh** Prop. of **True Travels** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ravinder Singh** Prop. of **True Travels** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Ravinder Singh** Prop. of **True Travels** the said accused of **CC No. 1498/2023, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Shalimar Bagh, North-West Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04,
(North-West) Room No.-112,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/14630/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H. O. "UJJAWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006. CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866
Tele.: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No.950 Date : 14.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil),Katapathar Barrage, UJVN Ltd., Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No:04/EE(Civil)/KB/2026-27
Name of work: Carrying out Plate Load Test and Modulus of Subgrade Reaction Test with complete setup and other allied works for Katapathar Barrage in District -Dehradun, Uttarakhand.
Estimated cost : ₹ 42,47,720.00 (GST Extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website : From 17:00 hrs of 15.10.2026
Last date for submission of bids : Up to 17.00 Hrs of 09.11.2026
For fuller & further details, kindly visite-procurement portal **"https://uktenders.gov.in"**

Executive Engineer (Civil)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No.: 8920262027 **Dated: 13.10.2026**

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tender on prescribed form for the following works up to **13:30 hrs.** On **05.11.2026**. The details of the tenders are as under:

SN.: 1	**Tender No.:** 187	**Approx Cost of Work (Rs.):** 1,02,70,870.93
Name of work: Kanpur-Central:- Construction of new building for Train Lighting office at Kanpur Central station under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB.		
Earnest Money (Rs.): 2,05,400.00	**Date Opening of Tender:** 05.11.2026	
Completion Period: 12 Months	**Similar work Eligibility Criteria:** Construction of Building	
SN.: 2	**Tender No.:** 188	**Approx Cost of Work (Rs.):** 4,81,04,601.22
Name of work: Govindpuri:- Improvement of Passenger facilities at Govindpuri Railway station under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB.		
Earnest Money (Rs.): 9,62,100.00	**Date Opening of Tender:** 05.11.2026	
Completion Period: 12 Months	**Similar work Eligibility Criteria:** Any Civil Engineering work	

Note:- 1. Tender on line can be submitted up to **13:30 hrs.** on **05.11.2026 2.** The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **13:30 hrs.** on the due date of tender opening i.e. **05.11.2026**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR 2332/26(K)

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No. TRD-KGP-W-2026-27-27, Dated 09.10.2026. For and on behalf of President of India, the Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD/Kharagpur-721301 invites e-tender for the following works before 15:00 hrs. on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15:30 hrs. **Description of works**: Electrical TRD work for "(i) Nimpura (NMP) R/Yard – Additional lines between line no. 18 of Nimpura (NMP) R/Yard and New Clinker siding. (ii) Provision of 06 Nos. of stabling lines at Nimpura (NMP) Reception Yard of Kharagpur Division". **Tender Value:** ₹ 2,31,82,812.61; **EMD:** ₹ 4,63,700.00; **Cost of tender document :** Nil. **Date of Opening:** 03.11.2026. **Completion Period:** 18 months. **Date of Submission:** upto 15:00 hrs. of 03.11.2026. Interested Tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details, description and specification of the tender and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for this work will be accepted. **Note:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all tenders. **(PR-892)**

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles.

VEHICLES FOR SALE

1) TATA MOTORS TLPT1912G REG. NO. HR38AH6046-YOM- 2024

UNDER HYPOTHECATION WITH M/S KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK IS UNDER SALE IN ITS "AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION" INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT BRANCH ADDRESS: KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK 3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7, SECTOR 125, NOIDA-201313 OR CONTACT : VAIBHAV TANWAR KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD. CONTACT NO. 9953750739 EMAIL-vaibhav.tanwar1@kotak.com

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PIRAMAL FINANCE LIMITED
(Formerly known as Piramal Capital & Housing Finance Limited)
Regd. Office Address:- 601, 6th Floor, Amiti Building, Piramal Corporate Park, Kamani Junction, Opp. Fire Station, L.B.S. Marg, Kurla (West), Mumbai- 400070
CIN: L64910MH1984PLC032639

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given to the public at large that Piramal Finance Limited (Formerly known as Piramal Capital & Housing Finance Limited) a Non-Banking Finance Company (NBFC) registered with Reserve Bank of India (RBI), having its registered office at 601, 6th Floor, Amiti Building, Piramal Corporate Park, Kamani Junction, Opp. Fire Station, LBS Marg, Kurla West, Mumbai – 400070, intends to close one of its branch located at **Piramal Finance Limited, 154 - A, 2nd Floor, A- Square Building, Civil Lines, Opp. D.M Residence, Railway Station Road, Bareilly – 243001, Uttar Pradesh** and the same shall be shifted to **Piramal Finance Limited, 2nd Floor, R.S. Tower, 165 Civil Lines, Station Road, Bareilly, Uttar Pradesh – 243001**. w.e.f. 01/12/2026.
The customers who are being serviced from the location which is being closed will be serviced from the new location from 01/12/2026 onward.
All the concerned persons are requested to take note of same.

Place: Bareilly
Date: 15/10/2026

Sd/-For Piramal Finance Limited
(Formerly known as Piramal Capital & Housing Finance Limited)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Tender Notice No. 24-Elect/G/PRYJ/2627 **Dated : 13.10.2026**

E-Tender Notice

Senior Divl. Electrical Engineer/Gen/N. C. Rly/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following e-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works up to **15:00** hrs. on **04.11.2026.** The details of the tenders are as under :-

TN. : ELG-57-2627	**Cost of work (In Rs.) :** 96,55,651.15
Name of work : Provision of Internal temporary lighting arrangement at Sangam Area, NYN, PCOI, PRYJ, SFG and BDL along with passenger's amenity requirements during Magh Mela 2026-27.	
Bid Security (in Rs.) : 1,93,100.00	**Duration of completion :** 04 Month
Tender Opening Date : 04.11.2026, 15:00 Hrs	
Note :– The complete information along with tender document of above e-Tender is available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in.** in up to **15:00** hrs. on the due date of tender opening. **2336/26 (AS)**	

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Ramjaan** S/o Md. Abdul R/o H. No. C-357, J.J. Colony, Bawana, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 351/2023 u/s 411 IPC at P.S. Bawana, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ramjaan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ramjaan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ramjaan** accused of FIR No. 351/2023 u/s 411 IPC at P.S. Bawana, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **11.12.2026.**

By Order: Ms. Bharti Beniwal,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North)
Room No. 114, 1st Floor,
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/14653/ON/2026

PIRAMAL FINANCE LIMITED
(Formerly known as Piramal Capital & Housing Finance Limited)
Regd. Office Address:- 601, 6th Floor, Amiti Building, Piramal Corporate Park, Kamani Junction, Opp. Fire Station, L.B.S. Marg, Kurla (West), Mumbai- 400070
CIN: L64910MH1984PLC032639

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given to the public at large that Piramal Finance Limited (Formerly known as Piramal Capital & Housing Finance Limited) a Non-Banking Finance Company (NBFC) registered with Reserve Bank of India (RBI), having its registered office at 601, 6th Floor, Amiti Building, Piramal Corporate Park, Kamani Junction, Opp. Fire Station, LBS Marg, Kurla West, Mumbai – 400070, intends to close one of its branch located at **Piramal Finance Limited, 2nd Floor, Bansal Complex, Near Jawahar Motors, Delhi Road, Moradabad - 244001, Uttar Pradesh** and the same shall be shifted to **Piramal Finance Limited, 2nd Floor, Plot No. 04, Khasra No. 278, Delhi Road, Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh 244001.** w.e.f. 01/12/2026. The customers who are being serviced from the location which is being closed will be serviced from the new location from 01/12/2026 onward.
All the concerned persons are requested to take note of same.

Place: Moradabad
Date: 15/10/2026

Sd/-For Piramal Finance Limited
(Formerly known as Piramal Capital & Housing Finance Limited)

NTPC Limited
(A Govt. of India Enterprise)

Advt. No.: 14/26

Special Recruitment Drive for OBC

NTPC Limited, India's largest integrated power utility, is driving the nation's progress with an installed capacity of over **91 GW** and a strong presence across the entire power generation value chain. Commensurate with our country's growth challenges, NTPC has embarked upon an ambitious plan to attain a total installed capacity of **149 GW by 2032.**
NTPC is launching **Special Recruitment Drive** for **OBC** candidates as per details given below:

Post	Vacancies	Grade / Pay Scale for Recruitment
Deputy Manager (Mechanical Erection)	03	E4 / IDA (Rs. 70000-200000)
Deputy Manager (C&I Erection)	01	
Deputy Manager (Civil Construction)	05	

Interested eligible candidates should log on to our website **careers.ntpc.co.in** or visit careers section at **www.ntpc.co.in** for viewing detailed eligibility criteria, qualification criteria, experience criteria, full text of the advertisement and for applying. The online application portal will remain open from **16.10.2026** to **30.10.2026**. Only online mode of application will be accepted. Any further addendum / corrigendum / updates will be published only on our website.

Leading the Power Sector

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001 for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	15265127	Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning DG Set	16 Set	03.11.2026
02	19260628	Set of Labyrinth Ring for Nose Suspend Drive	150 Set	09.11.2026
03	19261697A	Panto Foot Insulator	375 Nos	09.11.2026
04	77269008A RGC	Running Contract for IM Long Fish Plate	31676 Nos	16.11.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. **www. ireps.gov.in** for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained. **3573/2026**
Tender Notice No. 49/2026-2027 Dated: 13.10.2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No.: 2026-Oct-02 **Dated : 12.10.26**

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" Through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works. The Details of the tender are as under :

Tender No.: 2026-Oct-02-01	**Approx Cost Rs.:** 47750074.03
Description of work : TSR(P) By Contractor's PQRS Portal and other miscellaneous work in AGC-MTJ section.	

• For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway website **"www.ireps.gov.in"** • Tenderers can only be submitted through web portal **"www.ireps.gov.in"** up to **15:00** hrs on **05.11.26.** **2329/26 (C)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Krishan Kumar S/o Bhagwan Dass R/o T-29/2J, Road No. 20, Baljeet Nagar, Patel Nagar, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 205/2026 U/s 318(4)/336(3)/340(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Rajouri Garden, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Krishan Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Krishan Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Krishan Kumar** of case **FIR No. 205/2026 U/s 318(4)/336(3)/340(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Rajouri Garden, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Shashank Nandan Bhatt
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 356, 3rd Floor
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/14260/WD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Bharat @ Sunny S/o Bal Chand R/o H. No. D-1/118, Om Vihar, Phase-05, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 129/2017 U/s 363 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Bharat @ Sunny** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Bharat @ Sunny** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Bharat @ Sunny** of case **FIR No. 129/2017 U/s 363 IPC, P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **23.12.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Norma Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 22, 1st Floor, North East District
Karkardooma Courts, New Delhi

DP/14509/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
No. JHS/Comm/e-Auction/26/159 **Date: 12.10.2026**

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of The President of India, The Divisional Railway Manager, (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:

Category: Parcel	**Catalogue No.:** JHS-PARCEL-SLR
Asset Details	
(1) Train number 22194 = 01 SLR-F1 **(2)** Train number 12176 = 01SLR-F1	
(3) Train number 12320 = 01 SLR-R1 **(4)** Train number 12049 = 01 SLR-F1	
(5) Train number 22198 = 01 SLR-F1 **(6)** Train number 22195 = 01SLR-F1	
(7) Train number 11086 = 01 SLR-F1	
Auction Start Date & Time : 28.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs.	
Auction End Date & Time : 28.10.2026 at 12:30 hrs.	

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (**www.ireps.gov.in**). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **2326/26 (MG)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice No.JHS-N-W-80-26 **Date:** 12.10.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line **(E-Tendering)** for the following works.

E-Tender No.: JHS-N-W-80-26	**Approx Cost:** ₹26496792.08
Description of work: Jhansi-Sithauli-Provision of S&T work in connection with the work of Rebuilding/Replacement of various Stone Slab bridges by RCC Box/Slab under Jurisdiction of ADEN/LINE (41 No.)	
Earnest Money: ₹ 529900/-	**Cost of Tender Form:** Nil
Opening of tender: 05.11.2026 Time 15:00	
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance: 12 Months	

• Tender on line can be submitted upto **15:00 hrs on 05.11.2026.** • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in. (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T)** **2327/26(AK)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

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millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Mrs. Vipna Kumari D/o late Shri Ishwar Singh and W/o Shri Mohan Singh Thakur R/ o H. No. B-108, IIIrd Floor, Dwarkadhish North Golf Links Enclave Sector -26 Rohini, Pehlad Pur Bangar, North West Delhi, Delhi-110042, have changed my name from Vipna Kumari to Vipna Thakur after Marriage for all intents and purposes.

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited for execution of the following works by Chief Project Manager (Gati Shakti Unit), E.C. Railway, Dhanbad Dated: 09.10.2026
1. E-Tender No: 01-GSU-DHN-2026-27 2.Name of the work with its location & completion period: Provision of new station building connected with FOB for 2nd Entry of stations with road, Parking, boundary wall, Pathway, Porch, Drain, Horticulture, shifting of related utilities and other associated works at Gomoh, Parasnath, Hazaribagh Road, Koderma, Paharpur, Latehar, Daltonganj, Garhwa Road, Garhwa Town, Renukoot and Chopan Stations in Phase-II works along with work of 1st entry of Barkakana, Chopan & Daltonganj stations Under Gati Shakti Unit, Dhanbad division, East Central Railway. 12 (Twelve) Months **3. Approx. cost of work (In Rs.):** 120,61,79,503.77 **4. Earnest Money (In Rs.):** Earnest Money is applicable as shown in http://www.ireps.gov.in portal **5. Date & Time for closing and opening of e-tender:** Date of closing of e-tender at 12-00 hours on 09.11.2026 Date of opening of e-tender from 12:30 hrs. on 09.11.2026 **6.Website particulars: http:// www.ireps.gov.in** No manual tender will be accepted against-tendering. **Note :-** (i) In case of difference between Information in Hindi and English languages, only English languages will be valid. (ii) Prospective bidders are directed to take note of any changes and corrigendum in the process of issue of this e-tender, at least fifteen days prior to the date of closing of bid on the website http://www.ireps.gov.in

Chief Project Manager (GSU)
East Central Railway, Dhanbad

PR/1099/DHNGS/GS/T/26-27/48

QUOTATION NOTICE NO. 4 (2026-27)

Name of Work:- Sealed and subscribed quotation are invited by the Executive Engineer, North Mumbai Division - Andheri, Mumbai for Supplying items for the New Integrated High Court Complex at Bandra Government Colony, CTS No. 629/1234/A, Bandra (East), Mumbai. So as to reach this office on or before Date **14/10/2026** To **21/10/2026** Opening Date **22/10/2026** to **15.00 P.M.** and will be opened on the same day if possible.

Sr. No.	Description	Qty	Unit	Rate
1	**Providing and applying non-foaming PU (Polyurethane) waterproofing membrane below floor finish on prepared concrete surface, including surface preparation, PU-compatible primer, application of PU membrane in required coats to achieve specified thickness, treatment of joints, corners and junctions, complete as per manufacturer's specification and as directed by Engineer-in-Charge.**	1	Sqm	

Note:-
1. The rates should be quoted by excluding GST.
2. These rates are only for estimate purpose.
3. All item-wise details have been published online on the **https://mahatenders.gov.in** Please refer to these details and quote your rates accordingly.

The suppliers/ contractors/ firms/ should ensure that their quotation to submitted on or before the expiry of the date and time. This office on account of any cause will be entertained for the late receipt of the tenders / quotations will accept no delay. The rates for the said work are to be quoted by the company having 10 to 15 years of experience otherwise the rates will not be considered. Right to reject any one or all quotation is reserved by the undersigned.

No.EE/NMD/Tender/ 6063 of 2026 **12 OCT 2026**
Office of the Executive Engineer, North Mumbai (P.W.)
Division, Dadabhai Road, Near Bhavan's College, Andheri (West), Mumbai - 400 058.
Date:- Dgipr/2026-27/3239

Executive Engineer,
North Mumbai (P.W.) Division,
Andheri (West), Mumbai

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.
Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Rahul Sati/ Mamta Sati/ LBFDB00005793033/ LBFDB00005793035	Free Hold Entire First Floor, Without Roof/ Terrace Rights of Built UP Property Bearing No. 171, Pocket-3, Sector 25, Situated in Rohini Residential Scheme, Along With Proportionate Free Hold Rights Of The Land, Delhi 110085 & Free Hold Entire First Floor, Without Roof/ Terrace Rights of Built Up Property Bearing No. 172, Pocket-3, Sector 25, Situated in Rohini Residential Scheme, Along With Proportionate Free Hold Rights of The Land, Delhi- 110085/ October 13, 2026	July 21,2026 Rs. 40,60,190.00/-	Delhi

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: October 15, 2026
Place: Delhi/Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.



'A woman's no doesn't mean try harder'

Mrunal Thakur got candid about her new film 'Pooja Meri Jaan'

Mrunal Thakur said she offered to audition for her role in 'Pooja Meri Jaan' after listening to its one-line pitch about a trial in which the idea that a woman's 'no means no, it doesn't mean try harder' is challenged. Thakur, known for her roles in movies such as "Sita Ramam", 'Hi Nanna', 'Super 30', 'Batla House' and 'Dacoit', said it is rare to come across characters with that kind of range.

"The film was not offered to me. I asked the filmmakers if I could do and be a part of it. I asked for an audition and shamelessly I was like, 'Sir, you've got to cast me. I've got to play Pooja'. I found out about it via my agent, who said, 'There's a film being made which is about two girls fighting this case where 'no means no, it doesn't mean trying harder'. I was like, 'I've to be a part of it. Can I meet?' So, this is the second time in my life I've reached out to a filmmaker; that was Dino (producer Dinesh Vijan). I'm just incredibly happy that he saw that faith and he saw that I can pull it off," she told PTI in an interview.



THE FILM FOLLOWS POOJA (THAKUR), A FREE-SPIRITED WOMAN WHO REJECTS A MARRIAGE PROPOSAL FROM HER LONGTIME FRIEND

'Pooja Meri Jaan' follows Pooja (Thakur), a free-spirited woman who rejects a marriage proposal from her longtime friend. After he dies by suicide, leaving behind a note blaming her for his death, Pooja faces public backlash, with many holding her responsible. Her lawyer friend Sana (Huma Qureshi) steps in to defend her.

Thakur recalled her conversation with a man in his 40s during her recent visit to Delhi, who thanked her for the film because it made him aware of the importance of consent. "He said, 'There were so many times we didn't realise that we were putting pressure on a girl. When one of our friends liked a girl in college and she kept saying no. We kept telling him that he should try again. We didn't realise what she must be going through. So, I feel appalled. But today, I understood a woman's perspective of what she must be going through'," Thakur said, recounting the conversation.

Thakur said all the love that the film received has been overwhelming as an artist and she is just grateful that the producer and the director had faith in her. "After 'Pooja Meri Jaan', I've been getting a lot of opportunities and I'm just enjoying that because it's a lovely phase. If producers and directors are impressed by your work in a film and offer you their next, then that's the biggest compliment. So, I'm just happy for 'Maddock' and Navjot to see me as Pooja because it's a very, very difficult role," she said. PTI

'There is no pretension'

Vidya Balan expected trumpets for Rajinikanth's arrival on 'Jailer 2' set

Vidya Balan, who joins Rajinikanth in 'Jailer 2', expected the superstar's arrival on the sets to be nothing short of grand, befitting his larger-than-life image. Instead, he walked in quietly as she chatted with the director and other crew members, leaving her pleasantly surprised by his understated presence.

HIS MANNER MADE HER FEEL COMFORTABLE BEFORE SHE COULD EVEN REGISTER ANY SUCH PRESSURE

Speaking to 'Variety India', Vidya recalled the moment with surprise and admiration. She was already on set, talking to director Nelson Dilipkumar, the cinematographer and some assistant directors, when she noticed someone approaching from a distance.

"I was already on set, chatting with the director and the DOP and some of the assistants. We were all standing in a circle, just chatting and laughing. Someone began to walk towards us from a distance," she said. "I expected that his entry, you know, there would be trumpets at his entry. But he just walked in silently."

Balan said the understated first meeting was consistent with her experience of working with Rajinikanth throughout production. "There is so much to learn and appreciate and imbibe. There is no 'shosha'," she said, using the Hindi word for pretension or showiness. "And look at how he just presents himself as he is." AGENCIES



'Girls' to return a decade after series finale

Emmy-winning comedy series 'Girls', created by and starring Lena Dunham, will return with five new episodes, a decade after the show's finale.

HBO announced the return of the series, which will see Dunham reprise her role as Hannah Horvath alongside Allison Williams as Marnie Michaels, Jemima Kirke as Jessa Johansson, Zosia Mamet as Shoshanna Shapiro and Andrew Rannells as Elijah Krantz. The revival series will commence production in 2027, the American network said in a statement.

Dunham, who created, wrote, directed and starred in the series, said she had been waiting for a story that would make a return to the characters worthwhile. "We always said we would only return to GIRLS if there was a specific story we were burning to tell. I've missed these characters, but for a long time I couldn't quite picture them in the present day. Then, right around my fortieth birthday, they started talking to me in the shower," she said.



HBO ANNOUNCED THE RETURN OF THE SERIES, WHICH WILL SEE LENA DUNHAM REPRISE HER ROLE AS HANNAH HORVATH

The actress-filmmaker said revisiting the series offered an opportunity to look back at a project that had a significant impact on her life with greater perspective. "It's rare that you get the chance to return to something that changed your life with the gift of hindsight and a whole new level of gratitude and understanding," she added.

The new episodes will explore the characters as they approach or navigate their 40s, a significant shift from the original series. PTI

'I don't really care'

Lea Seydoux has moved on from her role as Bond girl Madeleine Swann and doesn't have an opinion on who should be cast as the new 007 spy.

The casting for the new Bond is underway, with several high-profile actors like Jacob Elordi, Aaron Taylor-Johnson, Henry Golding, Paul Mescal, Callum Turner, Jack Lowden, Jack O'Connell and Henry Cavill in the fray to fill in the spot left by Daniel Craig.

Seydoux reflected on her stint as a Bond girl during an interview with 'People' magazine at the London Film Festival premiere of 'Gentle Monster' on Saturday. "I really loved being on this franchise, but now it's ... done," Seydoux said.

ACTRESS LEA SEYDOUX SHARED HER THOUGHTS ON THE NEXT JAMES BOND

Asked who should take over the role of 007, Seydoux, 41, said, "I don't really care, to be honest. That's not my... It's over."

0Seydoux played a psychiatrist and the daughter of Mr White (Jesper Christensen) in 'Casino Royale' and 'Quantum of Solace'. Her romance with Bond began in the 2015 film and continued in 'No Time to Die'.

Craig played the character over five films: 'Casino Royale', 'Quantum of Solace', 'Skyfall', 'Spectre' and 'No Time to Die'. PTI



'Akshay Kumar's Hera Pheri 3 may never be made'

Ever since 'Hera Pheri 3' was announced, the much-anticipated comedy sequel has been embroiled in one controversy after another. From Paresh Rawal's abrupt exit and subsequent return to a legal battle over the franchise's rights and Priyadarshan stepping away as director, the film's future remains uncertain. The filmmaker has now said that he doesn't believe the third instalment will ever materialise.

In a conversation with 'Hindustan Times', Priyadarshan, who directed the original 'Hera Pheri' (2000), also spoke about why he declined Akshay Kumar's offer to direct 'Bhagam Bhag 2', explaining his reluctance to revisit successful films without a compelling story.

Asked about his decision to step away from 'Hera Pheri 3', he pointed to the numerous complications surrounding the project. "That has a lot of other complications, too many complications. I'd need chapters and chapters to talk about it," he said.

Asked whether he believes the third instalment will ever be made, the filmmaker replied, "I don't think it will ever get made". Speaking about 'Bhagam Bhag 2', Priyadarshan revealed that he turned down Akshay Kumar's offer to direct the sequel because he didn't want to revisit the 2006 comedy without a better story.

FILMMAKER PRIYADARSHAN EXPLAINED HIS RELUCTANCE TO REVISIT SUCCESSFUL FILMS WITHOUT A COMPELLING STORY

He said, "That is why I never do sequels because the reason that you are doing part two, it should be better than part one, like with the 'Terminator' franchise where part 2 was a better film than part one. Unless you have a much better story, you shouldn't do it. People always make a sequel when the first one really works, so if you don't better it, there is no value for the franchise." AGENCIES



Women need time & support: Divyanka

Tripathi opened up about postpartum bounce back expectations

Yeh Hai Mohabbatein' star Divyanka Tripathi fails to understand why women are expected to quickly return to their pre-pregnancy bodies after childbirth. The actress, who gave birth to twins in May this year, said women experience significant physical and emotional changes after childbirth.

'I DON'T KNOW WHETHER SOCIETY IS EVOLVING OR NOT,' QUIPS THE ACTRESS

"I don't know whether society is evolving or not; I just don't understand this. Also, to some extent, unrealistic expectations are reinforced by the standards established by actors," she told PTI in an interview.

She added, "For instance, if someone asks me, 'Wow, you bounced back in the third month', I will tell you, 'It's not wow'. I want to show the realistic picture; it isn't easy. You experience body pain and brain fog and you really need your family's support," she said.

Katrina Kaif recently faced trolling for gaining weight after the birth of her son, Vihaan, which sparked a debate online about the scrutiny that female actors face for their appearance.

Known for TV shows like 'Yeh Hai Mohabbatein', 'Banoo Mein Teri Dulhan', 'Khatron Ke Khiladi' and OTT series 'The Magic of Shiri', Tripathi, who is back on the small screen just six months after the birth of her twins, said it's not easy to bounce back physically.

"I feel I'm a new human being altogether. Now, I've got to make every single part of my body new again. So, it means a lot of hard work, patience and a lot of time." PTI

INDIA ENDED AT 223 ALL OUT IN 19.3 OVERS

Keemo Paul takes 5 as West Indies defeat India by 24 runs, tie series 2-2

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Hyderabad, October 14



Ishan Kishan walks off the ground after his dismissal as West Indies' Keemo Paul celebrates with teammates during the fourth T20I match, in Hyderabad on Wednesday PTI

Keemo Paul produced a match-winning five-wicket haul to wreck India's chase after Shai Hope's stunning hundred, as the West Indies secured a 24-run victory in the fourth T20 International here on Wednesday to force a series decider in Bengaluru. Paul returned figures of 4-0-41-5, claiming his second five-wicket haul in T20 internationals, after his 5/15 against Bangladesh in Dhaka in 2018. His decisive spell helped the visitors defend a formidable total of 247/3, built around Hope's unbeaten century, and level the five-match series at 2-2.

India ended at 223 all out in 19.3 overs.

India made an explosive start to the chase, with Sanju Samson taking the attack to the West Indies bowlers. The opener smashed 56 off just 23 balls, striking six fours and four sixes as the hosts raced to 60 without loss in four overs. Samson reached his half-century in just 20 deliveries, but Paul turned the contest in the fifth over by removing the opener and Ishan Kishan in quick succession.

Iyer moves up three places to career-high 4th in T20I rankings

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Dubai, October 14



India captain Shreyas Iyer jumped three places to a career-high fourth spot in the ICC's latest T20 International rankings for batters after making a blistering start in the ongoing five-match home series against the West Indies.

Iyer smashed his maiden T20I century during the series-opener in Lucknow and his rise to fourth means India have four players inside the top quartet of the rankings for T20I batters.

Iyer joined Ishan Kishan (top spot) and Abhishek Sharma (second) in the top-four with Sahibzada Farhan sandwiching the trio in third place. The Pakistan skipper reached a career-best rating following an impressive display against Sri Lanka, the ICC said in a press release.

Other players to make gains among T20I batters were Kusal Mendis (up three places to 23rd), Sherfane Rutherford (up 13 slots to joint 24th) and Sanju Samson (up four rungs to joint 27th).

Pakistan youngster Maaz Sadaqat rose from outside the top 100 to 45th following some decent efforts across the three-match series against Sri Lanka.

West Indies' Roston Chase improved in the rankings for T20I bowlers (up 24 places to 23rd) and T20I all-rounders (up two slots to third) following some excellent performances against India.

Haryana beat Himachal in Ranji Trophy

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Rohtak, October 14

Himanshu Rana and Dheeru Singh held their nerve as Haryana defeated Himachal Pradesh by seven wickets on the final day of their Group D Ranji Trophy match at the Bansi Lal Cricket Stadium here on Wednesday.

Resuming their second innings at 26 for three on the fourth day, Haryana chased down the 71-run target in 18.1 overs, with Rana scoring 37 and Singh remaining unbeaten on 24.

The duo added 51 runs off 63 balls to ensure there were no further hiccups as Haryana secured six points. Both batters had managed only single-digit scores in the first innings but stepped up when it mattered, guiding the hosts to victory after Himachal Pradesh had briefly raised hopes by taking three quick wickets on the third day.

Haryana had taken a 43-run first-innings lead after scoring 296 in reply to Himachal Pradesh's 253. Ankit Rajesh Kumar (59), Yashvardhan Dalal (72) and Kanishk Chouhan (50) scored half-centuries for the hosts. Haryana then bowled out Himachal Pradesh for 113 in the second innings to set up the modest chase. Anshul Kamboj was the pick of Haryana's bowlers, returning figures of 4/56 and 2/18 across the two innings.

Several seeded players knocked out of Fenesta Open

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 14

Several seeded players suffered shock defeats in the third round of the singles events at the Fenesta Open National Tennis Championship here on Wednesday.

However, the boys' U-16 and boys' U-14 respective top seeds Ribhav Saroha and Aarav Challani advanced to the quarterfinals.

Second-seeded Lakshya Chukka was knocked out of the boys' U-16 event after losing 2-6, 4-6 to Haryana's Harsh Marwaha, while third seed Paranjay Siwach went down 4-6, 4-6 to West Bengal's Monodip Dey, seeded 12th.

Marwaha said he was pleased with his performance, particularly in the second set, as he set up a quarterfinal clash against his doubles partner Vivaan Mirdha.

Saroha, who won the boys' U-18 title last week, continued his impressive run with a 6-2, 6-4 victory over 13th seed Gyansh Manchanda.



AROUND THE WORLD

- University Of Melbourne, IISER Tirupati launch dual degrees in science
- Calcutta University students to get 5 marks for attendance under new exam rules
- BIT Mesra hosted its 36th convocation recently
- IIT Guwahati researchers create brain-inspired device for low-energy visual processing
- IIM Lucknow concludes summer placement process for 42nd PGP and 23rd PGP-ABM Batch (2026–2028)

BUZZER ROUND

Q) Who is known as the 'Father of Indian Medicine'?

Send us your replies to careersmp22@gmail.com. We shall publish the names of the first 3 correct entries in next week's edition

Answer to our Sep 24 edition question: **1982**

Correct answers were sent by: **Samik Mondal, Anindya Majumdar, Prantika Basu**

NEWS & VIEWS

Almost 29 faculty members and one research graduate of the NIT Rourkela have been featured in the World's Top 2% Scientists List created by Stanford University and published by Elsevier and released via the Elsevier Data Repository.

Sumant Gupta, a Class 12 student from Delhi, who has won a Gold Medal for India at the 19th International Olympiad on Astronomy and Astrophysics (IOAA) 2026, held in Hanoi, Vietnam recently.

STUDY ABROAD

GERMANY, FRANCE & NEW ZEALAND EMERGE AS STUDY-ABROAD ALTERNATIVES

Indian students look beyond US, UK, Canada and Australia

ANINDITA ACHARYA



By now, it is well-known that India is the world's largest source of international students. However, visa uncertainty, particularly in the US, UK, Canada and Australia, coupled with stricter post-study work pathways and housing checks, has slowed the momentum of Indian students heading overseas. Before exploring the countries that are fast emerging as alternative study-abroad destinations, let's look at the numbers.

The US student visa rejection rate for Indian applicants rose from 53% in 2024 to 61% in 2025, with new enrolments and applications declining amid stricter scrutiny, appointment delays and policy shifts. International students, including Indians, are also feeling the impact of the UK Home Office's crackdown on study visas, with British universities revoking offers for certain courses. In March this year, Australia refused nearly 4,800 higher education visa applications lodged from overseas. In August 2025, Canada rejected 74% of Indian student permit applications.

In an earlier instalment of our 'Study Abroad' series, we examined how the Indian rupee's sharp depreciation against the US dollar and other major destination currencies has made overseas education considerably more expensive, driving up the cost of tuition, rent, food, health insurance and travel. However, changing visa rules for international students, including Indians, have emerged as another major reason why students and their families are reconsidering the old big-four overseas education destinations i.e. the US, UK, Canada and Australia. "The decline in outbound student numbers should not be interpreted as a decline in the aspiration for international education. That aspiration remains as strong as ever. What has changed is the way students and families are assessing overseas destinations, particularly in light of policy changes, economic uncertainty and the evolving geopolitical environment," opined Amit Garga, Co-founder, The WorldGrad.

Garga acknowledged that the US, Australia and Canada have introduced changes affecting international students, including their access to post-study opportunities, migration pathways and, in some cases, the overall scale of international enrolment. "At the same time, countries such as Germany, France, Italy, Ireland, New Zealand and the UAE are seeking to attract a greater share of international student demand. These destinations are becoming more visible in students' decision-making as they explore alternatives in terms of tuition costs, employability, visa conditions and long-term opportunities," he said.

According to Karan Lalit, Executive Director - South Asia, TOEFL & GRE, ETS, destinations such as Germany, Ireland and France are increasingly featuring in students' considerations. "Germany, in particular, has witnessed significant growth, with Indian enrolments at German universities rising by 17.5% to a record 69,816 students in the winter semester 2025/26, making Indians the largest international student group in the country. Ultimately, the Indian student today is not choosing a country merely based on familiarity; they are assessing which destination and programme best align with their academic goals, career aspirations and future opportunities," he said. Lakshmi Iyer Chief Client Officer & Chairperson, StudyIn India, also identified Germany as the clearest beneficiary of this shift, with some reports citing a year-on-year growth of over 70 per cent in student interest. The appeal stems from low or no tuition fees at public universities, strong industrial ties and structured post-study work options. "Ireland has also seen a marked jump, helped by English-medium instruction, a two-year post-study work window and strong demand in technology, pharma and finance. France, New Zealand, Singapore, Japan, South Korea and Malaysia are all drawing more first-time interest than they did even two years ago, particularly from students prioritising affordability and a clearer path from graduation to employment," she said.

The changing preferences are reflected in the numbers. According to Bureau of Immigration data cited by the Ministry of Education, the number of Indians travelling abroad for education fell from 8,94,758 in 2023 to 7,60,060 in 2024 and 6,19,264 in 2025. Tripti Maheshwari, Co-Founder Student Circus, believes policy unpredictability across Canada, the UK, Australia and the US has made the journey from admission to enrolment far less certain. Families are increasingly reluctant to commit lakhs of rupees to plans that could change midway. "With rising tuition, a weaker rupee and stricter post-study work rules, the gap between what a foreign degree costs and what it reliably returns has narrowed, pushing families to scrutinise outcomes far more closely than they did even three years ago," she said.

WHY DUBAI IS BECOMING A FAVOURITE AMONG INDIAN STUDENTS

Meanwhile, Dubai and the UAE are fast emerging as preferred study-abroad destinations for Indian students, with Indians accounting for roughly 42% of Dubai's international higher-education intake. Its proximity to India, direct flight connectivity, sizeable Indian community and cultural familiarity make Dubai feel like a "home away from home". Several universities in the emirate offer degrees affiliated with leading institutions in the UK and Europe, often at a more affordable cost than studying in the West. The region's rapidly expanding sectors, including AI, data science, business, hospitality and technology, also offer internship and employment opportunities, helping students transition from the classroom to the corporate world. Flexible study and work visa options, including the Golden Visa for high achievers, further make Dubai an attractive choice for students looking to plan their long-term careers.

SKILL GAP

PARENTS, TEACHERS CALL FOR ENTREPRENEURSHIP LESSONS IN SCHOOLS



OUR CORRESPONDENT

As India's MSME sector continues to fuel economic growth across the country, a new survey conducted by a school in Ghaziabad has captured a powerful shift in mindset among parents and teachers. According to the findings, over 72% of respondents believe that entrepreneurship and business skills should be introduced to students before their teenage years. Only 15% of those surveyed felt that schools are "very adequately" preparing students for the realities of today's business environment, while 58% described the current curriculum as "partially" or "not adequately" equipping the next generation of entrepreneurs.

This growing sense of urgency is reinforced by India's employment data. According to the India Skills Report 2026, just over half of Indian graduates are deemed job-ready, and employability rates are even lower for those coming from technical and vocational backgrounds, precisely the pool from which many MSMEs draw their talent. The survey findings suggest that the issue is not merely one of job creation, but of building real-world readiness and entrepreneurial capability from a young age.

82%

BELIEVE STUDENTS SHOULD UNDERSTAND HOW BUSINESSES MAKE MONEY FROM PRIMARY OR MIDDLE SCHOOL ONWARD

One of the most significant findings of the survey is the appetite for early business education: 69% of parents and teachers agree that children should start learning about entrepreneurship and business between the ages of 8 and 13, with nearly a third (31%) supporting introduction before age 10. A remarkable 82% believe students should understand how businesses make money from primary or middle school onward, rather than waiting until later years or relegating such knowledge to optional subjects. These statistics signal a fundamental shift in expectations, with parents and teachers demanding that entrepreneurship education be embedded within core learning, not treated as an afterthought.

Trending COURSES

EXECUTIVE MBA DEGREE FROM IIT MADRAS

Last date to apply is October 26

OUR CORRESPONDENT

IIT Madras has invited applications for its Executive MBA (EMBA) degree. This programme is de-signed specifically for mid-career working professionals. The last date to apply is October 26, 2026.

The two-year pro-gramme is a rigorous yet practice-oriented curriculum offered by the Department of Management Studies at IIT Madras, which is ranked in the top 13 B-schools in the NIRF ranking for 2025.

The programme is designed for blended weekend learning (physical and virtual). The classes, which will be held over alternate weekends, will begin in January 2027.

The eligibility for admissions includes first class Bachelor's degree in any disci-pline, minimum of three years of industry experience, and elec-tion through DoMS entrance examination and personal interview.

STRUCTURE OF THE PROGRAMME

- A functional foundation that provides theoretical, conceptual, and insightful understanding of major functions and department roles in businesses
- Integrated perspective which helps develop strategic perspectives on cross-functional challenges and inter-department synergies
- Global leadership, which explores growth, profitability, and sustainability avenues in local and global business contexts

10th Clifford Hicks International debate 2026 ends in style

The signature event of Calcutta Boys' School saw participation of more than 80 schools



AND THE WINNERS ARE

- **Awards for Category II (Classes IX & X)**
- **Prelims best speakers:** Akshat Choumal (M.C. Kejriwal Vidyapeeth, Liluah), Armaan Bhoopal (La Martiniere for Boys, Kolkata), Diya Chattopadhyay (Assembly of God Church School, Asansol), Nishant Gijare (Wisdom World School, Wakad)
- **Semi-finals: Best speaker:** Anay Singh (La Martiniere College, Lucknow). Winning Team: St. Xavier's Collegiate School, Kolkata
- **Finals: Best speakers:** Chayank Kausik (Bishop Cotton Boys' School, Bengaluru) and Nishant Gijare (Wisdom World School, Wakad). Winning team: Wisdom World School, Wakad
- **Optimus Orator, Electio Populi:** Pearl Sharma (Loreto Convent, Entally, Kolkata)
- **Awards for Category I (Classes XI & XII)**
- **Prelims best speakers:** Aditya Dasgupta (Welland Gouldsmith School, Patuli), Samriddha Chakraborty (La Martiniere for Boys, Kolkata), Deepangshu Mitra (M.C. Kejriwal Vidyapeeth, Liluah), Sarrah Dhariwala (The Bishop's School, Camp, Pune).
- **Semi-finals: Best speaker:** Ankana Dey (St. Teresa's Secondary School, Kolkata). Winning team: The Bishop's School, Camp, Pune.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Kolkata witnessed an extraordinary celebration of intellect, eloquence, and youthful energy as the 10th Clif-ford Hicks International Debate 2026 unfolded at Calcutta Boys' School (CBS) recently. Organized annually by the school's Literary Society in memory of the late Clif-ford Hicks, Principal and Secre-tary of CBS (1952-1974), the event has grown into one of the most prestigious debating platforms in India, attracting participants from across the country and abroad. The event seeks to inspire young debaters to emulate his ability to present arguments with acumen, without theatrics, but with unde-niable impact.

Principal and Secretary Mr Raja McGee welcomed 300 participants from over 80 schools and expressed his hope that the debate would go beyond competition to become an enriching experience for all. "We hope the debate will be able to form meaningful connections, encourage critical thinking and nurture leadership," he said. The competition was divided into two categories. Category I: Classes XI & XII Category II: Classes IX & X. Each category featured preliminary rounds, semi-finals, and finals, with the top seven teams from the prelims advancing to the finals. Delegates also enjoyed cultural tours of Kolkata, including visits to the Mother House, National Library, and Victoria Memorial Hall, alongside social gatherings such as the Rendezvous and Bada Khana at CBS.

THE EVENT HAS GROWN INTO ONE OF THE MOST PRESTIGIOUS DEBATING PLATFORMS IN INDIA, ATTRACTING PARTICIPANTS FROM ACROSS THE COUNTRY AND ABROAD

The debate saw participation from schools including La Martiniere College, Lucknow, St. Xavier's Collegiate School, Kolkata, Bishop Cotton Boys' School, Bengaluru, The Assam Valley School, and international representation from Aksharaa School, Nepal. The topics like global warming is just media hype, equality before law is a myth, and peer pressure is harmful, reflected pressing global and social concerns, challenging students to think critically.

The event was graced by well-known personalities, including Bishop Dr C Selvin and Madam Shanthi Lovely Selvin, and MP Sudip Bandopadhyay. The Category I Finals on October 9 marked the grand culmination of the 10th Clifford Hicks International Debate 2026. Adrish Hossain of Calcutta Boys' School emerged as the Best Speaker, also securing the coveted Optimus Orator, Electio Populi title, a dual recognition of both adjudicators' discernment and audience acclaim.